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PARLIAMENTARY DEBATES

OFFICIAL REPORT

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THE
PARLIAMENT OF THE REPUBLIC
OF GHANA

THIRD MEETING, 2025

Friday, 14th November, 2025

*The House met at the Chamber,
Parliament House, at 12:30 p.m.*

[MR FIRST DEPUTY SPEAKER, HON
BERNARD AHIAFOR, IN THE CHAIR]

[PRAYERS]

**FORMAL COMMUNICATION BY
THE SPEAKER**

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, it is in the form of announcement by the Rt Hon Speaker.

It gives me great pleasure to announce to this Honourable House that NIBS University in collaboration with the Parliament of Ghana, and under my distinguished leadership would be hosting a Breakfast Meeting to officially launch the Speaker's Scholarship for Parliamentarians and Parliamentary Service Staff.

This distinguished initiative, under the theme "Empowering Governance through Advanced Scholarships" is to enhance policy leadership and strengthen the institutional capacity of this Honourable House.

The details of the event of are as follows:

Date: Monday, 17th November, 2025

Venue: Sir Charles Emmanuel Quist Conference Room, on the First Floor of the Speaker's Block.

Time: 9:30 a. m.

I warmly invite all Hon Members to attend and actively participate in this significant occasion, which promises to advance our collective commitment to excellence in governance.

Thank you.

Hon Members, that is the Formal Communication from the Speaker. Now we take the item numbered 5 on the *Order Paper* —Correction of Votes and Proceedings and the *Official Report*.

**VOTES AND PROCEEDINGS
AND THE OFFICIAL REPORT**

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, we have *Votes and*

Proceedings of Wednesday, 12th November, 2025 and Thursday, 13th November, 2025.

We shall start with that of Wednesday, 12th November, 2025.

Page 1...7—

Yes, Deputy Minority Leader?

Ms Patricia Appiagyei: Mr Speaker, yesterday I think everybody will bear me out that I was conspicuously present in this Chamber but I have been marked absent.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Table Office, quickly take note.

Page 8—

Yes, Mr Richard Acheampong?

Mr Richard Acheampong: Mr Speaker, thank you very much.

I am sorry for taking you back to page 7. At page 7—Yesterday, Mr Emmanuel Kwadwo Agyekum, Ewurabena Aubynn, Mr John Setor Dumelo and Ibrahim Ahmed were all here—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, let us take note that the *Vote and Proceedings* under consideration is Wednesday, 12th November, 2025, not that of yesterday, 13th November, 2025.

Mr Acheampong: Mr Speaker, I am guided.

Page 9...10—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes?

Mr Abdul-Fatawu Alhassan: Mr Speaker, I want your guidance on something at page 10. I know *Votes and Proceedings* captures events, but I also want to know whether it also captures the sequence of the events. If it does, then when you look at page 10, the item numbered 8 and on the last line which

reads: “the Rt Hon Speaker withdrew from the Chair at 5:02 p.m.”—Now, if you go back to item numbered 9 (d), the Hon Member for Salaga South—

The First Deputy Speaker: Which *Votes and Proceedings* are you talking about?

Mr A. Alhassan: It is that of Wednesday, 12th November, 2025.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: On what page of that of Wednesday, 12th November, 2025.

Mr A. Alhassan: Turn to page 10, item numbered 8, which has where the Rt Hon Speaker withdrew from the Chair and you took over. If you look at page 9, you took over before, Ms Zuwera Mohammed Ibrahimah made her Statement on the former First Lady and we had another Statement from this Side on the former First Lady. At the time, you were in the Chair.

But the way it is arranged here, it appears all those Statements were made before you eventually took the Chair at 5:02 p.m. So, I do not know whether the sequence is anything we can also look at.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Well, probably they do not want to break the chain of the Statements to bring this before it, that is why the time that I took over was clearly indicated.

Page 11...23—

Hon Members, in the absence of any further corrections, the *Votes and*

Proceedings of Wednesday, 12th November, 2025 as corrected, is hereby adopted as the true record of proceedings.

Let us go to the *Votes and Proceedings* of Thursday, 13th November, 2025.

Page 1...7—

Yes, Mr Richard Acheampong?

Mr Acheampong: Mr Speaker, I am back again to page 7, the item numbered 2 of 4, Ms Ewurabena Aubynn was here yesterday and she has been marked absent, so if the Table Office can correct that.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Table Office take note.

Page 8—

Yes, Mr Frank Afriyie?

Mr Frank Afriyie: I am still on page 7, the item numbered 5(b)(ii), after the word “Johnson”, I will urge that we delete and insert “Asiedu”. In its current form, it is not “Asiedu”. Then, the same item numbered 5 (x), “Brigadier General Glover Ashong Annan”. My checks clearly shows that he is rather the Commissioner for Customs Division of the Ghana Revenue Authority (GRA). But what we have here against his name should be checked by the Clerks-at-the Table.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Table Office, please cross check and do the correct thing.

Mr Afriyie: Then again, on a minor note, the abbreviated nature of “Brigadier” here, should be looked at again. Normally, it is spelt “B-R-I-G” without the letter “D”.

Thank you.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, regarding the issue with the word “Brigadier”, that is what you may perceive to be the correct position. But what was written to the Table Office, is what has been captured. The written announcement that was given to the Table Office is what they have captured. So, between that written announcement and what you are saying, which one should we take to be the correct position?

Mr Afriyie: Yes, so I was only urging. Mr Speaker, I believe that my chairman’s name—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: To correct something, you need to be sure that what you are saying is the correct position. Why would you ask me to go and check something that is correct?

Mr Afriyie: We are guided by literature.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Thank you very much.

Hon Members, page 9...11?

12:40 p.m.

Hon Members, the *Votes and Proceedings* of Thursday, 13th November, 2025, as corrected, is hereby adopted as the true record of proceedings.

Hon Members, let us turn to *Official Reports*. We have *Official Reports* of 4th and 5th November, 2025. We shall start with 4th November, 2025.

Hon Members, any correction?

Mr Frank Afriyie: Mr Speaker, unfortunately, we have not been served with copies.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Is it not on the console? Emails were even sent to Hon Members. We are moving towards a paperless system, so they have sent you emails which contain the *Votes and Proceedings*, and on the console, we also have the *Official Report* of 4th November, 2025.

Hon Members, any correction?

[No correction was made to the Official Report of Tuesday, 4th November, 2025.]

Mr First Deputy Speaker: We also have the *Official Report* of 5th November, 2025 under correction.

Hon Members, any correction?

[No correction was made to the Official Report of Wednesday, 5th November, 2025.]

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, the item numbered 6, Business Statement for the fifth week.

Vice Chairman of the Business Committee?

Minority Chief Whip (Mr Frank Annoh-Dompreh): Mr Speaker, our Hon Colleague should resume his seat because the Business Statement is supposed to be presented by the Chairman of the Committee as the Orders provide. So, the Deputy Leader knows what to do. He should respect the Chair by making the due application and that decision will have to be taken by the Chair, whether he will take it instead —

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, right from the onset, I granted that application when the Majority Leader indicated at the lobby that he may not be around. So, Vice Chairman, you have the Floor.

BUSINESS OF THE HOUSE

Vice Chairman of the Business Committee (Mr George Kweku Rickets-Hagan) on behalf of the Chairperson: Mr Speaker, your Committee met yesterday, Thursday, 13th November, 2025 and arranged Business of the House for the Fifth Week ending Friday, 21st November, 2025.

Mr Speaker, the Committee accordingly submits its report as follows:

Arrangement of Business**Question(s)****Formal Communications by the Speaker**

Mr Speaker, you may read any available communication to the House.

Mr Speaker, the Business Committee has scheduled the following Ministers to respond to Questions asked of them during the Week:

No. of Question(s)

i. Attorney-General and Minister for Justice	5
ii. Minister for Fisheries and Aquaculture	4
iii. Minister for Roads and Highways	10
iv. Minister for the Interior	5
v. Minister for Food and Agriculture	5
vi. Minister for Foreign Affairs	8

Total Number of Questions

 37

Mr Speaker, in all, six Ministers are expected to attend upon the House to respond to thirty-seven (37) Questions during the Week. The Questions are of the following types:

Urgent – 6 Oral – 31

Statements

Mr Speaker, pursuant to Order 91(2), Ministers of State may be permitted to make Statements on Government policies. You may also admit Statements by Hon Members in accordance with Order 93.

Bills, Papers and Reports

Mr Speaker, in accordance with Order 159, Bills may be presented to the House for First Reading. However, those

of urgent nature may be taken through the various stages in a day in accordance with Order 160.

Pursuant to Order 97, Papers may be laid during the week and reports from Committees may also be presented to the House for consideration.

Motions and Resolutions

Mr Speaker, Motions may be debated and their consequential Resolutions, if any, taken during the week.

Referrals at Committees

Mr Speaker, attached is the list of pending referrals before the Committees for the attention of the House as part of effort to remind the respective Committees to expedite work on the

referrals and report to the House. A total of 292 referrals have been made to 25 Committees for consideration and report to the House. Hon Members are hereby notified that the Committee has commenced scheduling the laying of Reports on referrals at Committees. Committees so scheduled are expected to present the Reports for consideration by the House.

Mr Speaker, the Business Committee urges all Committees to prioritise consideration of the referrals and promptly report to the House in accordance with Order 267(4).

Commentary on the Budget Statement and Economic Policy of Government

Mr Speaker, pursuant to Order 195(3), the Business Committee has programmed the commentary on the Budget Statement and Economic Policy of the Government to commence on Tuesday, 18th and end on Wednesday, 26th November, 2025.

Mr Speaker, the Committee proposes that the commentary be scheduled in the various sectors provided below and by day:

DAY	SECTOR(S)
Tuesday, 18 th November, 2025	Finance Budget Economy Public Interest
Wednesday, 19 th November, 2025	Agriculture Trade and Industry Tourism, Culture and Creative Arts Environment, Science and Technology
Thursday, 20 th November, 2025	Roads and Highways Transport Works, Housing and Sanitation Energy and Green Transition
Friday, 21 st November, 2025	Lands and Natural Resources Defence and Interior Local Government Legal Judiciary
Tuesday, 25 th November, 2025	Gender and Social Protection Health Education
Wednesday, 26 th November, 2025	Conclusion of the Commentaries by the Majority and Minority Leaders

Accordingly, the Business Committee, recommends the following time allotments for contributions by Hon Members:

Majority Leader & Minority Leader	-	1 hour
Other Leaders	-	30 minutes
Ministers	-	15 minutes
Chairpersons & Ranking Members of Committees	-	15 minutes
Vice Chairperson & Deputy Ranking Members	-	10 minutes
Other Hon Members	-	5 minutes

Submission of Budget Estimates

Mr Speaker, the Business Committee urges the Ministry of Finance, other Ministries and Independent Constitutional Bodies to submit estimates to the House timeously for the consideration and approval.

Post-Budget Workshop

Mr Speaker, in view of the presentation of the Budget Statement and Economic Policy of Government, a post-budget workshop is scheduled for Saturday, 15th November to Monday, 17th November, 2025 at Alisa Hotel, North Ridge - Accra. Hon Members are entreated to take note and participate fully.

12:50 p.m.

Conclusion

Mr Speaker, in accordance with Standing Order 216 (2) and subject to Order 67 of the Standing Orders of Parliament, the Committee submits to the House the order in which the

Business of the House shall be taken during the Week.

Tuesday, 18th November, 2025

Roll Call

National Pledge

Statements

- (a) The Budget Statement and Economic Policy of the Government for the year ending 31st December 2026.

- *Commentary on the Statement to commence*

- (b) **Dr Thomas Winsum Anabah (Garu)**: To make a Statement on closing the Physician Gap in Ghana – Global Perspectives and Strategic Options.

- (c) **Dr Stephen Amoah (Nhyiaeso)**: To make a Statement on making Entrepreneurship part of Ghana's Basic and SHS Academic Curricula.

- (d) **Mr Akwasi Gyamfi Onyina-Acheampong (Kwabre East):** To make a Statement on the Challenges of the Cashew Industry in Ghana.

Urgent Questions

- (a) **Osahen Alexander Kwamena Afenyo-Markin (Effutu):** To ask the Attorney-General and Minister for Justice the basis for the administrative decision by EOCO to demand justification as a bail condition for suspects in recent times particularly appointees of the previous Government.
- (b) **Mr Mumuni Muhammed Nurideen (Nalerigu/Gambaga):** To ask the Attorney-General and Minister for Justice the plans of the Ministry to extradite Sedinam Tamakloe who was convicted for misappropriating funds.
- (c) **Rev John Ntim Fordjour (Assin South):** To ask the Attorney-General and Minister for Justice, what steps the Ministry is taking to ensure expeditious prosecution of criminal narcotic cases.

Questions

***349. Prof Kingsley Nyarko (Kwadaso):** To ask the Attorney-General and Minister for Justice how the Ministry intends to protect the integrity of the judiciary and also exude confidence in the citizenry in our judicial system.

***440. Mr John Darko (Suame):** To ask the Attorney-General and Minister for Justice the immediate measures the office of the Attorney-General is implementing to safeguard and promote fundamental human rights particularly in response to recent reports of arbitrary arrests, prolonged pre-trial detention and alleged abuses of suspects.

***348. Mr Duke William Allen Kwame Amoako-Atta Ofori-Atta (Fanteakwa South):** To ask the Minister for Fisheries and Aquaculture how the Ministry intends to ensure the targeted 38,604.32 metric tonnes increase in Aquaculture production in 2025 is achieved and what monitoring mechanisms are put in place to track output by regions.

***361. Mr Rudolf Amoako-Gyampah (Upper Denkyira West):** To ask the Minister for Fisheries and Aquaculture how the Premix Fuel Automation Project is addressing issues of diversion, hoarding and safety and the solutions strategy the Ministry is developing to improve transparency and distribution efficiency.

***362. Ms Shirley Kyei (Atwima Nwabiagya South):** To ask the Minister for Fisheries and Aquaculture when the proposed Blue Economy Commission will be established and what legal or institutional framework will guide its operations.

***363. Mr Rudolf Amoako-Gyampah (Upper Denkyira West):** To ask the Minister for Fisheries and Aquaculture how the Ministry intends to

ensure the targeted 38,604.32 metric ton increase in Aquaculture Production in 2025 is achieved and what monitoring mechanisms are in place to track output by region.

Presentation of Papers

- (a) Report of the Finance Committee on the Annual Report on the Management of the Energy Sector Levies and Accounts for the Year 2024.
- (b) Report of the Finance Committee on the Budget Performance Report in Respect of the Ministry of Finance for the Period January to December, 2024.
- (c) Report of the Finance Committee on the Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Securities and Exchange Commission for the year 2024.
- (d) Report of the Finance Committee on the Annual Report on Public Private Partnership Projects for the year 2024.

Motions

Second Reading of Bills

- Ghana Deposit Protection (Amendment) Bill, 2025

Private Members' Motion

- That this honourable House inquires into what accounts for the vast differential learning outcomes

and performance in exit examination in Senior High Schools (SHS) across the country what also accounts for challenges during computerised school placements into SHS and to make appropriate recommendations for better regulation of the management of Senior High Schools to achieve even learning outcomes across the country.

Committee sittings

Wednesday, 19th November, 2025

Roll Call

Statements

- (a) The Budget Statement and Economic Policy of the Government for the year ending 31st December 2026.

- Commentary to continue

- (b) **Mr Eric Edem Agbana (Ketu North):** To make a Statement on the need to upgrade the Ohawu Agricultural College into a fully-fledged Agricultural University.
- (c) **Ms Laurette Korkor Asante (Atiwa West):** To make a Statement on Maternal Mortality in Ghana.
- (d) **Mr Ntebe William (Tatale-Sanguli):** To make a Statement on the poor demarcation of electoral boundaries and overcrowded polling stations as root causes of election disputes in Ghana.

Questions

***513. Mr Kwame Anyimadu-Antwi (Asante Akim Central):** To ask the Minister for Roads and Highways when the Ministry would consider the construction of the Praaso, Nyabo, Obenimase, and Kyekyebiase roads.

***514. Mr George Kwame Aboagye (Asene/Manso/Akroso):** To ask the Minister for Roads and Highways why the road construction from Agona Swedru to Akim Oda has come to a halt for several months and when the contractors will resume work.

***376. Mr Yao Gomado (Akan):** To ask the Minister for Roads and Highways the measures being taken to construct the road between Asato and Apesokubi, which is the shortest route for the people of the Akan constituency to access the Oti Regional Hospital.

***455. Mr Sanja Nanja (Atebubu/Amantin):** To ask the Minister for Roads and Highways what immediate measures the Ministry is implementing to fix the potholes on the Amantin and the Yeji stretch of the Kumasi-Yeji Highway to prevent further deterioration of the road.

***298. Mr Duke William Allen Kwame Amoako-Atta Ofori-Atta (Fanteakwa South):** To ask the Minister for Roads and Highways when a traffic light will be installed at the Osino intersection on the busy Accra-Kumasi highway.

***374. Mr Frank Asiedu Bekoe (Suhum):** To ask the Minister for Roads and Highways whether the Ministry has any plans to construct footbridges on the Accra-Kumasi highway.

***379. Mr Maxwell Kwame Lukutor (South Tongu):** To ask the Minister for Roads and Highways the current state of the Tofle Town Road Project awarded sometime in 2020.

***385. Mr Kwame Appiah Kodua (Fanteakwa North):** To ask the Minister for Roads and Highways when the Miaso-Asirebuso to Owusukrom road will commence after the contractor left the site.

***475. Mr Kwabena Boateng (Ejisu):** To ask the Minister for Roads and Highways the current state of the Besease – Jamasi road in the Ejisu Constituency, particularly when work will resume to complete the road.

***512. Ms Shirley Kyei (Atwima Nwabiagya South):** To ask the Minister for Roads and Highways when the construction of the following abandoned roads will be resumed and completed (i) Maakro – Agogo- Twedie (ii) Supreme Saviour – Canaan.

Presentation of Papers

- (a) Report of the Public Accounts Committee on the Follow-up Report of the Auditor-General on the Three Performance Audits in respect of: Regulating Small-Scale Mining for a Sustainable Environment; Sustainability of

Sports Stadia in Ghana; and Administration of Scholarships by the GETFund.

- (b) Report of the Public Accounts Committee on the Report of the Auditor-General on the Statements of Foreign Exchange Receipts and Payments of the Bank of Ghana (BoG) for the Half-Year Ended 30th June 2024.
- (c) Report of the Public Accounts Committee on the Special Audit Report of the Auditor-General on the recoveries made from disallowed expenditure in the Auditor-General's Reports from 2020 to 2023 and payroll savings as at 31st December 2024.
- (d) Report of the Public Accounts Committee on the Report of the Auditor-General on the Public Accounts of Ghana: Public Boards, Corporations and other Statutory Institutions for the Period Ended 31st December, 2024.

Motions

Committee sittings

Thursday, 20th November, 2025

Roll Call

Statements

- (a) The Budget Statement and Economic Policy of the Government for the year ending 31st December 2026.

- Commentary to continue

(b) **Mr Vincent Ekow Assafuah (Old Tafo):** To make a Statement on the urgent need to prioritise and invest in Ghana's Boxing.

(c) **Mr Seidu Haruna (Wenchi):** To make a Statement on motivating the youth as a tool to boost agriculture under the Feed Ghana Initiative.

Urgent Question

Mr Frederick Yaw Ahenkwah (Jaman North): To ask the Minister for the Interior when the curfew imposed on Sampa Township on 18th of April 2024 as a result of some Chieftaincy disputes will be lifted.

Questions

***343. Mr Sulemana Alhassan (Yunyoo):** To ask the Minister for the Interior plans the Ministry is implementing to address the pressing security concerns in the Yunyoo/Nasuan District to establish a dedicated district police command rather than sharing with Bunkpurugu District.

*** 344. Mr Sulemana Alhassan (Yunyoo):** To ask the Minister for the Interior what measures are being taken to deploy additional police personnel to the Yunyoo/Nasuan District to effectively address the rising crimes and armed robbery incidents.

***394. Mr Lawrence Agyinsam (Hemang Lower Denkyira):** To ask the Minister for the Interior the plans of the Ministry to furnish the two district police

stations in the Twifo Hemang Lower Denkyira District that face transportation challenges and logistical support.

***549. Mr Charles Owiredi (Abirem):** To ask the Minister for the Interior whether the Ministry has developed a long-term strategy for electoral security reform particularly one aimed at curbing the impunity of politically motivated violence during elections.

***429. Mr Kwame Dzudzorli Gakpey (Keta):** To ask the Minister for Food and Agriculture how much funds Ghana has received from international organisations to combat drought in northern part of Ghana and how it has been used.

***273. Mr Richard Kuuire (Nandom):** To ask the Minister for Food and Agriculture when the Farmers Services Centre at the Nandom Constituency will be established and made operational.

***342. Ms Ida Adjoa Asiedu (Ayensuano):** To ask the Minister for Food and Agriculture what training or capacity-building programmes are available for farmers to improve their skills and knowledge on modern farming practices.

***425. Mr Richmond Edem Kofi Kpotosu (Ho Central):** To ask the Minister for Food and Agriculture the Ministry's projected number of months for food security in case of global pandemic.

***464. Mr Akwasi Gyamfi Onyina-Acheampong (Kwabre East):** To ask the Minister Food and Agriculture the plans of the Ministry to ensure sustainable prices for actors in the Cocoa value chain including farmers, licensed buying companies and transporters.

Presentation of Papers

- (a) Report of the Committee on Local Government and Rural Development on the Annual report of the District Assemblies Common Fund for the year 2023.
- (b) Report of the Committee on Local Government and Rural Development on the Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Births and Deaths Registry for the year 2024.
- (c) Report of the Committee on Local Government and Rural Development on the Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Krachi East Municipal Assembly for the year 2024.
- (d) Report of the Committee on Local Government and Rural Development on the Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Jaman North District Assembly for the year 2024.

Motions

Committee sittings

Friday, 21st November, 2025

Roll Call

Statements

- (a) The Budget Statement and Economic Policy of the Government for the year ending 31st December 2026.

- *Commentary to continue*

- (d) **Mr Issah Atta (Sagnarigu):** To make a Statement on opportunities for trade facilitation within and among African countries: challenges, weaknesses, and the way forward.
- (b) **Mr Ntebe William (Tatale-Sanguli):** To make a Statement on the poor demarcation of electoral boundaries and overcrowded polling stations as root causes of election disputes in Ghana.
- (c) **Ms Dorcas Afo Toffey (Jomoro):** To make a Statement on the Economic Empowerment and Financial Literacy of Women.

Urgent Questions

- (a) **Mr Samuel Abdulai Jinapor (Damango):** To ask the Minister for Foreign Affairs how many Ghanaians are affected by the Executive Order 14159 of the President of the United States of America titled “Protecting the American People Against Invasion” and the measures the

Ministry has put in place to ensure their safety.

- (b) **Mr Samuel Abdulai Jinapor (Damongo):** To ask the Minister for Foreign Affairs what assessment was conducted on Third-Party Deportees and their potential risk to Ghana’s security, and social stability before receiving them into the country.

Questions

***472. Rev John Ntim Fordjour (Assin South):** To ask the Minister for Foreign Affairs which factors accounted for Ghana’s “abstain” vote taken at UN Human Rights Council in Geneva in July 2025 in respect of renewing the mandate of Independent Expert on LGBTQ rights.

***416. Mr Kwame Dzudzorli Gakpey (Keta):** To ask the Minister for Foreign Affairs the current state of Ghana’s chancery in Nigeria given recent reports of deterioration, and what measures the Ministry is implementing to rectify structural defects, outdated furniture and improve poor sanitation.

***191. Mr Frank Asiedu Bekoe (Suhum):** To ask the Minister for Foreign Affairs the strategy of the Ministry for the new foreign policy document. per the National Security Strategy of 2020

***329. Mr Emmanuel K. Ntekuni (Pru West):** To ask the Minister for Foreign Affairs the efforts being made by the Ministry to locate and bring back the Ghanaian youth who are currently

trapped in La Cote d'Ivoire by Q-Net under the guise of aiding them to travel to Europe and other countries for greener pastures.

***330. Mr Frank Asiedu Bekoe (Suhum):** To ask the Minister for Foreign Affairs the psycho-social support the Ministry has taken to help the Foreign Service workers/Diplomats and their families who were asked to leave Ghana embassy in Washington impromptu.

***439. Mr Emmanuel Tobbin (Anyaa Sowutuom):** To ask the Minister for Foreign Affairs and Regional Integration the strategic objectives the Ministry seeks to achieve through the establishment of a new mission in Hungary and what resources have been allocated for its operationalisation.

Presentation of Papers

- (a) Report of the Committee on Public Administration and State Interests on the Annual Report on the Staffing Position of the Office of the President for the Period 1st January to 31st December 2024.
- (b) Report of the Committee on Public Administration and State Interests on the Budget Performance Report in respect of Office of the Head of the Civil Service for the Period January to December, 2024.
- (c) Report of the Committee on Public Administration and State Interests on the Annual Statement by the

Audit Committee of the Office of the President for the year 2024.

- (d) Report of the Committee on Public Administration and State Interests Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Office of the Head of Civil Service for the year 2024.

Motions

Committee sittings

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Thank you, Hon Vice-Chairman of the Committee.

Hon Members, the Business Statement is duly presented. I now welcome comments. The floor is open.

Yes, Hon Member?

Mr Alexander Akwasi Acquah: Mr Speaker, with regard to the days allotted for commentary, I did not hear anything on the Ministry of Defence and the Ministry for the Interior.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Well, Hon Member, have you looked at page 2, table 4, Friday, 21st November, 2025?

Yes, any other comments?

Mr Acquah: Mr Speaker, I am trying to.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Very well.

Yes, Mr Ekow Assafuah?

Mr Vincent Ekow Assafuah: Mr Speaker, I realised that one of my Statements has been accepted and scheduled for me to present on 20th November, 2025, meanwhile, I actually submitted two Statements. For the other one, I have not heard anything about it. I do not know whether it has been accepted, or corrections would have to be made —

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Well, I would advise that you get in touch with the Table Office so that you can resolve it with them.

Mr Assafuah: Secondly, I also have Questions that have been filed for about three weeks now —

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Similarly, liaise with the Table Office.

Mr Assafuah: That I did, and I have not received any response from them.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: So, liaise with them.

Yes, Hon Member?

Mr Vincent Oppong Asamoah: Mr Speaker, let me draw attention to the Committee on Works, Housing and Sanitation. We have two Committees; they are the Committee on Works and Housing and the Committee on Sanitation and Water Resources. So, if it can be separated.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Where have they put them together? And why do you ask that it be separated?

Mr Asamoah: Mr Speaker, they are now two separate Committees.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes. They are dedicating that particular day for the two sectors to debate.

Mr Asamoah: All right. I thought it would be the Committee on Sanitation and Water Resources, separate from the Committee on Works and Housing.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: They are not doing it on a daily basis, and it is not also on a Committee basis. It is not as if they are dedicating one day to a Committee, or would it be done on Committee basis.

Hon Members, any further issues?

Yes, Mr Frank Afriyie?

1:00 p.m.

Mr Frank Afriyie: Mr Speaker, I thank your Committee particularly the Chairman for the Statement. My concern is on the subject matter contributors. Over here, we have been clearly told how many times each Member depending on the category they fall in could contribute. May I know, like my Committee, the Committee on Local Government and Rural Development, is the ratio the same as we had the last time?

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, I think you are getting it wrong. It is not how many times you speak, but rather how many minutes you speak. What is indicated here is that the Majority Leader and the Minority Leader

will have one hour, and other Leaders will use 30 minutes, Ministers will use 15 minutes, Chairman and Ranking Members will use 15 minutes, Vice Chairperson and Deputy Rankings will use 10 minutes and other Hon Members will use 5 minutes.

Mr Afriyie: Mr Speaker, clearly, I was trying to refer to the time allocation. My point is that, on a sector like Local Government—*[Interruption]*

Mr First Deputy Speaker: They are not allocating the time per Committee.

Mr Afriyie: Mr Speaker, my contention is not on the time allocation for the various sectors. Mine is about how many Members per the two Sides can speak on a particular sector.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: That is not an issue for the House to decide. It is an issue for the Leadership to decide. So, contact your Leaders. It is not a subject matter for discussion by the House.

Yes, Mr Chiwitey?

Mr Andrew Dari Chiwitey: Mr Speaker, I was just wondering if it is possible to plead with Leadership, the two Leaders, to reduce their time. One hour? We have many Members who want to say two or three things. If they could reduce their time to maybe 45 minutes, then we would have more Hon Members contributing. If not—One hour? Well; that is my view. I plead with Leadership. Let us look at it, so that we have 45 minutes for Leaders, then the 15 minutes could be shared among other

Members to also have their say. Thank you so much, Mr Speaker.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Well, it is a good suggestion. Leadership, take note. Yes?

Mr Nana Agyei Baffour Awuah: Mr Speaker, thank you very much for indulging me. I have gone through the Business Statement, and I see nothing on the El-Wak military recruitment disaster. Very respectfully, I do agree that there are ways by which some of these things come. However, I also think that on our own accord, we can initiate a discussion on it so as to come across to the Ghanaian people to be sensitive and concerned. It is a very big disaster which should not repeat again. Mr Speaker, I think that the Business Committee ought to capture it.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: What are you expecting the Business Committee to capture on the El-Wak disaster?

Mr Awuah: Mr Speaker, there are various tools by which we do our work. Respectfully, you are a repository of the processes and procedures in this House. Even when the young ones like us do not know how to have it raised, given the national importance of what happened—six young women lost their lives.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member—

Mr Awuah: Several of them have been injured. Mr Speaker, we cannot pretend as Parliament—*[Interruption]*

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, kindly resume your seat.

Mr Awuah: Mr Speaker, we cannot pretend that nothing has happened. [Uproar] That is what is happening. Something must be done.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, your conduct is becoming disorderly.

Mr Awuah: Oh, so you do not care? You do not care about the dead?

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, may you resume your seat!

Hon Members, we were in this House when the Hon Minister for Defence, came to brief the House and indicated that a Committee is being formed to investigate the matter. We have taken two Statements, one each from both Sides. So, if you want an issue to be tabled you know what to do. You know what to do. Hon Members, the Speaker indicated that we will now be using the hammer, so kindly take note.

Yes, Hon Member?

Mr Frank Annoh-Dompreh: Mr Speaker, if you may indulge me on the subject matter of the unfortunate incident that occurred at El-Wak Stadium. You rightly recalled that there were Statements. I also do recall that the Speaker gave some consequential directives, that the Committee of Defence and the Interior should engage on the matter and report to Plenary. I can understand the worry of the Hon

Member. Probably, what we should look at is, because of the urgency associated with the matter, we could give some timelines, because the Speaker has already directed that the Standing Committee on Defence and the Interior should delve into the matter and report to us. Maybe we could give them a fortnight or three weeks for them to report to the Plenary for Parliament to engage on. But I recall vividly that those were the marching orders of the Speaker.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes. Clearly you are right. All these things have happened. When the matter is referred to a committee, the Rules are clear as to when the committee is supposed to Report. I do not intend to vary the orders of the Rt Hon Speaker by way of giving timeline to the Committee. The time within which the issue is supposed to be reported to this House is spelled out clearly by the Rules of the House. Hon Members, I do not intend to vary the directives of the Rt Hon Speaker. Let us not create the impression that when the incident happened, Parliament did not do anything. I am reliably informed that the Committee on Defence and the Interior have started some work on it. They have done some visitations, and they are working.

Well, on this note, I will yield the floor to the Vice-Chairman to respond to issues that need to be responded to.

Mr Ricketts-Hagan: Mr Speaker, on the issue of the time allotment for the Leaders, it is only the two of them who are speaking on the 26th November, 2025. Even if we lessen the one-hour

allotment, it does not allow anyone else to speak on that day. I am sure that many contributions will be taken as possible on the day that is relevant to a particular subject area or sector. So I do not think that should be a problem. It was properly thought through and there would not be any need to reduce the time for the Leaders to speak.

I think the other issue Mr Speaker has addressed it. The matter, as you rightly said, has been referred to the Committee on Defence and the Interior. So we await the submission of the Report for further discussion on it.

These are the two matters that I think I recollect were asked. If there is anything else that I am missing, if my attention can be drawn to that, then I will respond to that. Thank you, Mr Speaker.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Thank you.

Yes, Mr Kyei Asamoah.

Dr Fred Kyei Asamoah: Mr Speaker, thank you very much. On page 2, the debate schedule, the sectors, I realised that Chieftaincy and Religious Affairs is conspicuously missing. Even though I see Culture and Creative Arts on Wednesday, the 19th of November. If, maybe, that of Chieftaincy and Religious Affairs could be placed with the Local Government.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, that is a good observation.

Yes, Prof Kingsley Nyarko?

Prof Kingsley Nyarko: Mr Speaker, thanks for indulging me. On the page numbered 3 of the Business Statement, I have seen that the numbering is different. One is page 1, page 2, then the next one, page 1, page 3. Also, the post-Budget workshop, which is scheduled to take place at Alisa Hotel, I would like to know whether it is residential or non-residential.

My second issue has to do with—if you look at the console, I have seen that the principal documents we use in this House, the Standing Orders is captured on the console, but the 1992 Constitution is not captured. If it is possible for us to also have the 1992 Constitution placed on the console, we will be grateful.

My last one has to do with—during our meeting with the Public Utilities Regulatory Commission (PURC) on Wednesday, we observed from the Ghana Water Company Limited's presentation that the condition of the rivers is extremely poor, with very high turbidity levels. I wanted to file an Urgent Question to get the Minister for Works, Housing and Water Resources to be here. But, looking at the pace of time, I would like to plead with you, if it pleases you, to have the Minister for Works, Housing and Water Resources to at least brief us about the measures the Minister is taking to ensure that the water is treatable and right for consumption. It is so bad, and the costs involved in treating the water is so high. Because of the space of time, in filing an Urgent Question, if it is possible for us to get the Minister here to explain to us what he is doing to ensure that the water is not poisonous and is conducive for consumption.

1:10 p.m.

Thank you, Mr Speaker.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, let me do a bit of correction. I think we are all making this mistake. If you file a Question, do not just leave it there. Follow up to ensure that your Question is admitted. Before the Question can be admitted, your Whips must recommend the Question or the Statement for admission. Now, when it is admitted, it is transmitted to the Clerk. Then, when it comes to programming, you must again follow to ensure that your Question is programmed to be taken. It is not possible for the entire House or the person presiding to know that you have filed a Question but it did not appear. But if you follow it up with the Table Office, then you remind them that the Question that you have filed needs to be programmed, so a little bit of follow-up would help in the circumstances.

Prof Nyarko: Mr Speaker, with respect, it seems you did not get my point. I am saying that I wanted to file an Urgent Question, but because of the space of time and also the commentary on the Budget Statement and Economic Policy of Government that we are going to have, I am pleading with you that if possible, instead of filing the Urgent Question, we could programme the Minister to come here within next week to apprise us of what he is doing to ensure good water quality for our consumption. The Question is not yet filed because of the space of time. But if it is possible, and this request finds favour with you, and you can programme him for us, I would be happy.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Kingsley Nyarko, if the space of time cannot allow the Urgent Question, which will result in the Business Committee programming the Minister to come here, what space of time would allow the Business Committee to *suo motu* programme the Minister to come and brief the House?

Prof Nyarko: Mr Speaker, you win.

Mr Samuel Abdulai Jinapor: Thank you very much. Mr Speaker, may I refer you to page 7 of the Business Statement where Urgent Questions have been captured. Mr Speaker, I filed three Urgent Questions relating to our relations with the United States of America. These Questions were directed at the Minister for Foreign Affairs. I see that two of the three Urgent Questions have been programmed to be taken on Friday, 21st of November.

Mr Speaker, for want of time, I will not quote the first two Questions, but there is a particular Question which the Table Office acknowledged and referred to the Minister, which has not been captured. Could I crave your indulgence to see if there is space for that Question to be captured? This is because that Question relates to whether the agreement or memorandum of understanding with the United States of America to receive third-country deportees has been ratified by Parliament in accordance with Article 75 of the Constitution.

Indeed, Mr Speaker, you would recall that I think last week or two weeks ago,

the Majority Leader in presenting the Business Statement actually committed and promised that the Minister will be coming to the House to brief the House on this particular agreement. I was just craving your indulgence, if that particular Urgent Question can also be programmed to be taken for this particular day, since the Minister is appearing before the House to answer these Questions.

Mr Speaker, to conclude, the subject matter is important because we know that even today there are issues relating to how these deportees are being treated in our country.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, you have made your point. May I crave your indulgence to get in touch with the Table Office?

Mr S. A. Jinapor: Mr Speaker, I am extremely grateful.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Let me add the Hon Member for Chiana-Paga, then I will give the Hon Deputy Majority Leader the floor, then we will come to Leaders.

Mr Alamzy Billa Nikyema: Thank you very much, Mr Speaker. My point is on the commentary of the Budget Statement and Economic Policy of the Government of Ghana on page 2, the item numbered 4 (c) “Other Hon Members five minutes.” Mr Speaker, I am talking on behalf of the other Members that do not have any position. The five minutes is always inadequate for us to make any meaningful

contribution. So, I want to beg Leadership, and we are going to beg them through you that, at least, if they can make it seven minutes or 10 minutes for us, we will be able to also make some meaningful contribution. This would be better than always starting before we can make any major contribution, the time will be up. So, we are pleading through you, Mr Speaker.

Mr Ricketts-Hagan: Mr Speaker, first of all on the issue of the post-budget workshop, it is going to be non-residential, though it is happening at Alisa Hotel. So, the idea is to close at a decent time, around 5 o'clock, so that Members will be able to reach their homes on time. But it is non-residential, that is my understanding.

On the issue of putting in chieftaincy, maybe, together with local government, we will have to look at that with the Clerk because we have local government here. Just as we will have employment and labour relations with public interest on the Tuesday. Mr Speaker, I think I am done, unless there is any other.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Leadership, starting from the Minority.

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: Mr Speaker, with respect, my Colleagues will come in, but I need to step out for another meeting, so they have obliged me. I would just raise two issues.

Firstly, Mr Kojo Oppong Nkrumah had raised this issue of government policies not being announced in Parliament, the initiatives that have been

talked about. We had assurances from the Hon Majority Leader that steps are being taken to programme the Ministers to discuss these policy initiatives with Parliament. That has not been programmed yet, so I would want to crave the indulgence of the Deputy Leader to follow up on that.

Secondly, Mr Speaker, this disaster that occurred at the El-Wak Sports Stadium, yes, the Minister briefed us on the occurrence. However, interventions are matters that are important to this House. It is important for the Minister to be programmed, to share with us what steps the Military High Command is taking to prevent the reoccurrence of this matter. The respected Minority Chief Whip, in his Statement, called for certain actions to be taken. Mr Speaker, we should not have Parliament as a mere talk shop.

Our condolences to the bereaved families, but this is not one of the matters that we should just talk about and allow to die. Six young citizens losing their lives because they are looking for a job is very important. Some are still in the hospital, and Parliament must enquire into this.

1:20 p.m.

The Minister must brief us.

So, Mr Speaker, it is very critical —

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Minority Leader, I recall that after the Statement, the Speaker gave some consequential directives to the

Committee on Defence and Interior. And that is one tool that Parliament can use to enquire into matters of this nature.

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: Mr Speaker, I was right here. Respectfully, I agree with you, that is so. But I am talking about ministerial action.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: But you said Parliament must enquire.

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: Yes, I am saying that —

Mr First Deputy Speaker: After the directives have been given to the Committee on Defence and Interior?

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: Mr Speaker, for want of a better word, sometimes we all make mistakes in language use. I would therefore yield to that. What I meant to say was that, with Parliament giving the mandate to enquire, it is equally important for ministerial action to be taken for briefing. In any event, that ministerial action would perhaps serve as a primary data, the primary source of information to aid Parliament. That is the reinforcement I wanted to seek.

Mr Speaker, the other thing of concern for us as a Minority is this issue of bail conditions. We know that —

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Bail conditions at where?

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: Mr Speaker, lately, a lot of our compatriots are being prosecuted. They are issued

with criminal summons, they go themselves, and when they go, very onerous bail conditions are imposed on them.

Mr Speaker, we are not in any way bringing this matter up to attempt interfering in judicial processes. No. We are raising it as a matter of national concern, the impression we give.

I would want to make a call on the Leader of the House to programme the learned Attorney General and Minister for Justice to apprise us on some of these matters. Mr Speaker, if a bail is imposed mainly because of a charge sheet or the fact of the case, without the other party being heard, it is quite worrying. We are concerned, and we believe that if perhaps the Attorney General and Minister for Justice comes here to brief us on why we have some of these onerous bail terms, we would be able to interrogate the matter. Because it is quite serious, where a court grants bail and the accused would be in custody for several weeks. Mr Speaker, it is quite worrying.

Mr Speaker, my last point has to do with a Question that has finally featured in the Business Statement. The item numbered 1(iv)(a) which reads:

“To ask the Attorney-General and Minister for Justice the basis for the administrative decision by EOCO to demand justification as a bail condition for suspects in recent times particularly appointees of the previous Government.”

Mr Speaker, it is long overdue. Each time it features, there is one excuse or the other. I would want to plead with the Table Office to ensure proper transmission of the Question for it to be received by the learned Attorney General and Minister for Justice. Because the Question is of national concern. It has been there since March, and each time, the learned Attorney General and Minister for Justice is unable to appear.

So, I do not want it to just feature without action. Table Office, please, it is coming on the 18th —

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, you have been given a date for it.

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: Mr Speaker, I do not want to sleep on my rights. We get it programmed, and each time there is one excuse or the other. It is the reason I am raising it for the first time. I have never raised this.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, but some excuses may be due to an act of God.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Mr Speaker, it is possible. Perhaps, the Minister is having a press conference and is unable to come. That could also be another —

Mr First Deputy Speaker: But that cannot be an act of God?

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: It could also be another reason. But, Mr Speaker, I think I would rest my case on this. The Deputy Majority Leader says we should

be *bɔkɔ bɔkɔ*, so we would be. There is no problem today, so we would handle him gently. I am sure he is happy.

Mr Speaker, I am done.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Any more from the Minority Leadership?

First Deputy Minority Whip (Alhaji Habib Iddrisu): Thank you, Mr Speaker.

The Chairman of the Business Committee indicated that debates on the Budget would commence on Tuesday. I just wanted to draw his attention and ask if he could make hard copies of the Budget available so that Members could have it and prepare for the commentary on Tuesday.

Also, I know that you have stated that under Order 159 —

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, I have some information for you. Every Member has a copy of the Budget in their pigeonhole already.

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: Thank you, Mr Speaker. I am guided.

Mr Speaker, the Chairman indicated that under Order 159, Bills may be presented. But the Human Sexual Rights and Family Values Bill, the anti-LGBTQ+ Bill, has been in the burner for long. It surfaced and the last time the Speaker gave some commentary on it. It has taken too long. When would we introduce the anti-LBGTQ+ Bill in Parliament?

Also, last week, the Minority Leader drew the attention of the Majority Leader to the unfortunate incident of the helicopter tragedy that happened on 6th August. Parliament has not been officially briefed, even though the Committee has submitted its Report.

So, it was agreed that we should get the Ministers responsible, either the Minister responsible for Defence or the Minister for the Interior, to brief the House with regard to this matter. Mr Speaker, when we listened to the Budget yesterday, we realised that the Government intends to buy four helicopters and two jets. The Government intends to spend US\$1.2 billion. And if it is a response to what has happened, the tragedy of 6th August —

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Alhaji Habib Iddrisu, kindly take note that at this point, we are considering the Business Statement, but not debating the Budget. The appropriate time would be made available for you to debate the Budget. For now, we are considering the Business Statement.

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: Mr Speaker, rightly so. What I was saying is that, last week, it was agreed that the Minister responsible should be programmed to appear before the House to brief us on what happened. The Committee that His Excellency the President set up have submitted their report, but we have not been briefed. I was just making the point that, yesterday, in the Minister for Finance's presentation of the Budget Statement, there was an indication that they are going to buy four helicopters

and two jets at a cost of US\$1.2 billion. If it is a response to the tragedy that happened, then we need to be briefed as a House.

Mr Speaker, I have not gone into the details of debating the Budget. I am just passing a comment. But it is a fact that they want to buy four helicopters and two jets.

I am saying that it is public knowledge that you intend to buy four helicopters and two jets, so let me make my point —

1:30 p.m.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon First Deputy Minority Whip, kindly do the needful.

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: Thank you, Mr Speaker. It is just that some of the Backbenchers do heckle a lot. They do not need to argue with me. Mr Speaker, I do not know why he is arguing. Whether he was here before me or not, I am a Leader and I am on the Frontbench, and he is there, so he should understand that.

Mr Speaker, usually, when we get to the consideration of the Budget Estimates, the copies delay. So, if the Chairperson of the Business Committee could make sure that the Budget Estimates do not delay—Because we might be moving about 30 to 40 Motions in this House.

Mr Speaker, thank you.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, any other issue?

Mr Dafeamekpor: —*rose*—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Please, I will come to the Majority Side and take your comments.

Yes, Hon Minority Chief Whip, with all due respect, I am now dealing with the Leadership.

Mr Frank Annoh-Dompreh: Mr Speaker, let me thank the Hon Deputy Majority Leader for the presentation.

I will start off by making some observations on the number of Questions that have been scheduled for the ensuing week. I see five Questions for the Attorney-General and Minister for Justice, and four for the Minister for Fisheries and Aquaculture. Except for the Minister for Roads and Highways, all the other sectors such as employment, land, education, tourism have less than 10 Questions, but I know for a fact that we have a backlog which include a number of Questions. The Hon Deputy Majority Leader would agree with me, there was an earlier position of a ten-question rule, that we take 10 Questions per day, in an attempt to ensure that we dispense of the backlog as practically as possible.

So, I want to humbly suggest—I am aware we have the debate of the Budget Statement, but we had also agreed that notwithstanding the debate, we will still take Questions. After the debate, Motions, after which we would be

heading towards Appropriation. It will be practically impossible to be able to take many of the 300 Questions that are outstanding. I am a Member of the Business Committee and I want to suggest that we make room to, at least, respect the ten-question per day rule. Let me also suggest that because we will be having the debate, we should also be looking at extended Sittings which when adopted by the House, we can have the ten-questions per day rule, manage it by reducing the follow-ups, so that eventually, we would be able to do away with as many Questions as possible. If we speak to many of our Colleagues, there is a yawning worry on the number of Questions that are still outstanding, and colleagues are quite worried about it. So, if the Hon Deputy Majority Leader can take this in stride—

We see the attachment of over 200 referrals. That is quite historic and the last time, the position of the Majority Leader was that we should schedule these referrals and cause the Committee Leadership to come and speak to them. Well, it may be a good attempt, but if we have scheduled the Chairpersons of the Committees, and the reports are not ready, it may be much ado about nothing. I want to humbly suggest that both Sides of Leadership should probably be engaging these Committee Leaders. They may be having a genuine cause, because 290 referrals, still outstanding, cannot be ordinary. So, we may be seeing this challenge from our point of view. We have to also appreciate how they see the challenge from their point of view. Then we can be attempting to meet each other midway in the resolution of the problem.

We have given our word that we will help the Majority Side to ensure smooth prosecution of Government Business. But typically, the Committee Cluster system itself is a challenge. It may have its benefits, but during the course of the Budget, especially when we start demanding reports for the Motions to be taken, it has always been a challenge. When we were on the other Side, it was a challenge. So let us find a way of engaging the Clerk to Parliament and the Table, so that for the Budget, we could compromise on the cluster system, and rather adopt a system where we can deal with these Motions as soon as possible.

Then there is also a challenge with the printing room. I am being practical here and with that one maybe I can relate. They have real challenges. Mr Speaker, there are some issues which I would not want to elucidate on the floor of the House. We have to find a way of getting them ready, so that when we start the Motions, we can take them as many as we should.

My last one has to do with Questions on lands. I have a copy of a letter which has been submitted to the Minister for Lands and Natural Resources. The fact of the matter is, it was the Minister for Lands and Natural Resources, and the Minister for Labour, Jobs and Employment. The two sectors were due in terms of their Questions, and the Minister for Lands and Natural Resources assured us that he is ready to come and answer the Questions next week. I have seen that all the Questions that stood in the name of the Minister for Lands and Natural Resources had been

reprogrammed. But we left out that for the Minister for Labour, Jobs and Employment. We should not allow this to add on to the backlog.

Mr Dafeamekpor: —*rose*—

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: Mr Speaker, I am helping the Hon Majority Chief Whip's work. Yes, but I am talking about— So the one for Minister for Labour, Jobs and Employment should be added to the one for Minister for Lands and Natural Resources. We do not want excuses. Already, many of the Questions have been left out. So, we plead with them. The few that we have agreed on, let us give prior notification and reminders to the Ministers that this House will not accept [*Expunged by order of Mr Speaker*] all those excuses. It is not tenable. So that we can deal with as many of the backlog Questions as possible. Well, we can see it is very popular from the reaction from their Side. They want their Questions answered. Otherwise, his back will be empty. All their Questions are not being answered.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, I direct that —, should be expunged from the record.

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: Mr Speaker, that is fine, I respect the decision. But I know some Ministers who like [*Expunged by order of Mr Speaker*]. But that is a discussion for another day.

So, I plead with the Hon Deputy Majority Leader that those Questions, let us try and up the numbers a bit.

Basically, I am saying that we should try and give them notification for them to be aware and come and answer the Questions. I wanted to relate to the post-Budget workshop, but the Hon Majority Chief Whip says he wants to relate to that one. So, I may probably leave that one for him.

Mr Speaker, I thank you.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Deputy Minority Leader, do you have any issue to comment on?

Yes, I will now come to the Majority Leadership.

1:40 p.m.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, I will come to the Majority Leadership.

Mr Rockson-Nelson Etse Kwami Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, thank you for the opportunity and let me commend my Leader for ably presenting the Statement.

Mr Speaker, if I recall correctly, the directive we gave at the meeting yesterday was that we should indicate to the committees when they should present Reports on the referrals. But inadvertently, what has been advertised is just the referrals. So, we were directed to inform the committees that, from next week on a specific date, the House expects Reports of the committees in respect of the referrals that have been made and advertised. But what we have done is a re-advertisement of the referrals. So, if they can take note.

Two, if we look at page three of the Report, the item numbered six on the Post-Budget Workshop. Mr Speaker, last week, by this time, we announced a seminar for the Leadership of Committees, just leadership. And, if the Minority Chief Whip will bear me out, we struggled to even whip our Members, even though it was in-house. And because Members have competing interests, we struggled to get them to attend. That was even for leadership.

Now, we are just being informed that the post-Budget retreat will be non-residential. Mr Speaker, we want to plead with the Clerk to make the Post-Budget Workshop a residential one. This will make the work of myself and the Minority Chief Whip easy, so that we can get full participation of Members. If somebody is in Kasoa and we are asking the person to drive to Accra on Monday morning to attend a Post-Budget Workshop, the person may not prioritise it. That is why it is important that the Whips are consulted on these matters. We were not consulted, and it is unfortunate that I have to bring this matter to the Floor.

If I do not have my Members in-house, it is difficult for me to keep them from their homes or wherever they are especially on a weekend, when funerals and other social activities are competing for their time. So, Mr Speaker, we are pleading with you to speak to the Clerk, to as much as possible, let the Post-Budget Workshop be residential, so that Members can have the full attention to participate fully. The essence of the Post-Budget Seminar is to equip Members

with the requisite ability to debate the Budget Statement effectively. I do not want to have an empty seminar chamber, and then we the Whips are blamed.

Number three, I would want to plead with the Clerk's office to distribute the budget documents that were submitted yesterday. As we speak, Members are complaining that they have not received their copies. They have been to their pigeon holes. They are telling—with all due respect, Members have come to me so many times today.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Majority Chief Whip. You are a Government Whip. So, I think for certain matters, you can liaise with the Leader of Government Business, and then we can get the issue resolved.

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, I take the guide, but I am saying that the budget distribution ought to have been done expressly yesterday, when they were presented, for Members to begin to read. Sometimes, you are compelled to bring these matters. This is not about the Leader of Government Business, Mr Speaker, with all due respect, but this is about the Clerk's Office. The distribution is delayed, and Members will blame the Whips for not having the documents.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, you know the Clerks do not print the Budget.

Mr Dafeamekpor: I have spoken with the Clerk to have the budget documents distributed to Members

expressly, before close of Business today. These will be my comments on this matter.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon First Deputy Minority Whip, I believe strongly that we should all appreciate the method we have adopted; the Majority was quiet, I give the floor to the Minority. And when you are done, I will give the floor to the Majority. So, please, for once.

Yes, Deputy Majority Leader.

Mr Ricketts-Hagan: Mr Speaker, I think you gave a guide on the issue that the Minority Leader raised, which had to do with the unfortunate disaster at El-Wak Sports Stadium. So, I believe that we are all waiting on the directive of the Speaker, which is to get a Report and then take the matter further.

The issue of the bail condition, Mr Speaker, has no space in my Business Statement here, but I will discuss it with my Leader. The Budget documents, as I understand, are being distributed now into the various pigeon holes. But I want to assure Members that by the end of today, everyone will have a hard copy of the budget, because that is what we would work with over the weekend when we are having the budget workshop.

I am not quite sure, but I recall that Hon First Deputy Minority Whip was at the Business Committee when the Leader raised the LGBTQ issue, and added that he needed to find his space and get it here. But I will relate that to the issue of the Questions. Mr Speaker, yes,

we have a lot of backlogs that we need to clear, and my concern is that the manner in which we ask Questions and answer them here does not usually allow us to take as many Questions as possible.

Sometimes when one has a Question and there are follow-ups, it tends to go on. According to our Standing Orders, Order 77(2), I believe, we are supposed to spend an hour on Question Time. But sometimes we spend three hours which pushes everything back, and we are not able to accommodate as much as we should. But when I look at next week, considering that we will be debating the Budget, I have counted the Questions, and on average, we have about eight Questions a day.

1:50 p.m.

So, we are quite close to the 10 you are talking about, considering that next week is also the debate on the Budget. I think that should be all right. But going forward, we need to keep an eye on making sure that we get the Questions that we have agreed on.

I would also urge Leadership to guide Members and make sure that the Questions are asked and follow-up questions are asked precisely and we are able to keep to the one-hour time limit that we have given to it. If we spend three hours for taking Questions, then we probably will not be able to achieve much. So, it should actually cut both ways, in terms of how we go about this.

I think in the next Business Committee meeting, we need to discuss

a few things and streamline them. I do agree with you on the cluster issue and I think that obviously needs to be discussed with the clerks and the Table Office to make sure that we resolve that issue. As he said, he did not to mention the printing room issue here, so I would not also want to mention it here. We will make sure that we get the issue resolved.

Mr Speaker, I do not think the helicopter issue has any space here. We have a Budget debate coming next week. The Hon Member may want to discuss his helicopter matters, but not in a Business Statement for today.

Mr Speaker, thank you very much.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Alhaji Habib Iddrisu?

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: Mr Speaker, I am grateful. I related with the Majority Chief Whip on the issue that I wanted to address, so it is all right.

Thank you.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Thank you very much.

Hon Members, the Business Statement as presented is hereby adopted.

Hon Members, permit me to acknowledge the student guests in our midst.

We have New Avalavi, M/A Basic School, led by Owusu Moses, the teacher. They are from the Ketu North Constituency and are 71 in number.

Then, we have Mighty Vision Educational Complex, led by Odei Bismark, the teacher. They are from the Atiwa East Constituency and are 60 in number.

Then, we have Twifo Hemang Senior High School, led by Piizie Francis, the teacher. They are from Hemang Lower Denkyira and are 70 in number.

We also have Great Assurance Preparatory School, Akim Eshiem. They are led by Sam Kweku Frederick, the proprietor of the school. They are from the Asene Manso Akroso Constituency and are 63 in number.

We also have Saltpond Catholic Boys and Girls, led by Philip Kweku Sagoe. He is the NCCE Director of the area. They are from the Mfantseman Constituency and are 129 in number.

[Pupils of New Avalavi, MA Basic School were acknowledged.]

[Pupils of Mighty Vision Educational Complex School were acknowledged.]

[Pupils of Twifo Hemang Senior High School were acknowledged.]

[Pupils of Great Assurance Preparatory School were acknowledged.]

[Pupils of Saltpond Catholic Boys and Girls were acknowledged.]

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, on your behalf, I welcome all of them to the Parliament of Ghana and wish them a fruitful visit.

Thank you.

Hon Members, the next item after the Business Statement is the item numbered 7—Statements. We have seven Statements. I want some guidance from the Leadership regarding the number of Members to comment on each Statement.

Yes, Deputy Majority Leader?

Deputy Majority Leader (Mr George Kweku Ricketts-Hagan): Mr Speaker, as you rightly said, we have seven Statements, here. But I engaged my Friends on the other Side and we have agreed that we want to look at three on our Side, since they have only one from their Side. So that we will do four Statements. So, we will make three Statements from our Side and then the one that is on the other Side will also be taken. So that will be four Statements for today. But if they want to say something, I would yield to him.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Minority Chief Whip?

Mr Frank Annoh-Dompreh: We are trying to find a road map. It is difficult to execute all seven Statements. Mr Speaker, I have related to my Side and there are a number of Statements that have been submitted, pending confirmation from your outfit. I just transmitted one to your outfit. So, I humbly want to suggest that we can add one to our Side, to the existing one, so that it becomes two.

We take three Statements from their Side and then two from their Side, it becomes five in total and then we can call it a day.

Mr Ricketts-Hagan: Mr Speaker, I think that is in your hands. Since it has not been advertised, he is making a prayer for Speaker to decide on that one.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, the difficulty is to ignore an advertised Statement and take a Statement that has not advertised. That is the difficulty.

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: Mr Speaker, we are in your hands.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes. I do not know which particular one is coming from your Side.

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: Mr Speaker, I am sorry, if you may, endure, we have the one lettered “e” that stands in the name of the Mrs Laurette Korkor Asante. I have transmitted another one that stands in the name of the Mr Vincent Assafuah. So that, it sums up to two Statements from our Side.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: When was it transmitted? Because I have not seen it.

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: It was displayed on the console.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Is it admitted?

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: Mr Speaker, we are in your hands. That is why we are making pleadings to you that we get that one added to the one advertised, so that it becomes two on our Side.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Are you sure the second Statement you are talking about is on the console?

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: Well, that was the information I got, that it was on the console. Whatever it is, we are pleading with you that, we should have that one added to make it two Statements.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, I am telling you about a clear difficulty. I want to be fair to all manner of people. Assuming you have a Statement advertised, the advertised one which is yours would not be taken. But the one that is not advertised should be taken—

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: Mr Speaker, Leadership has a role to guide—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, I know the Leadership has a role to play. But this issue of the Statement not coming from this Side or the other Side.

I have presided over the House and I have taken more Statements from my left Side than the right Side. So, for me, if you are agreeing that we take the first two to four, or let us take this number of the Statements out of the ones admitted and advertised, then I would agree with you. Other than that, it defeats the purpose of having the Statements advertised.

Well, Leadership, you can engage, and then I would give the floor to Mr Isaac Awuku -Yibor, Member of Parliament from Domeabra, Obom, to make the Statement numbered item number 7 (a).

2:00 p.m.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: So, Leadership you can engage. How many comments are we even taking? That is what you should be advising me on.

Yes, Hon Isaac Awuku Yibor, you have the Floor.

STATEMENTS

Urgent Need for Insurance and Safety Regulations for Workers on High-Rise Construction Projects and Billboard Installations

Mr Isaac Awuku Yibor (NDC — Domeabra Obom): I rise to make a Statement on the urgent need for insurance and safety regulations for workers on high-rise construction projects and billboard installation.

Thank you, Mr Speaker, for the opportunity to address this august House on this matter of grave national concern that directly affects the safety, well-being, and the economic security of countless hardworking Ghanaians across our urban centres.

Mr Speaker, this concern is the growing risk associated with the construction of high-rise buildings and mounting of billboards and signage on

towering structures across the country. As Ghana continues its urban transformation, our cities are expanding vertically. The skyline is increasingly inundated with multi-storey buildings and massive advertising billboards.

While these developments contribute to urban modality and economic activity, they also expose a category of informal and often unprotected workers to life-threatening hazards.

Mr Speaker, our artisans, including billboard installers, painters, electricians, masons, and carpenters routinely operate at significant heights, many times without adequate safety gear or insurance protection. This informal segment of the construction and advertising industry is growing rapidly, yet remain under-regulated and under-protected.

Mr Speaker, data from the Ghana Statistical Service and Labour Advocacy Group indicate that accidents involving construction and signage workers on high-rise projects are steadily increasing. A 2023 report by the Ghana Institution of Safety Engineers revealed that construction-related fatalities ranked among the top five occupational deaths in the country, with significant proportion involving falls from height. Yet, most of these workers are not enrolled in any form of insurance or social protection scheme.

Recent incidents in cities like Accra, Kumasi, Takoradi, and Tamale have heightened the tragic consequences of

the regulatory gap. Injuries, permanent disabilities, and in some cases deaths, all without compensation or support for affected families.

Mr Speaker, this issue transcends labour rights. It is a public safety and urban governance challenge. Many Metropolitan Municipal and District Assemblies (MMDAs), despite ensuring permits for outdoor advertisement, lack the capacity to enforce basic occupational safety standards.

Mr Speaker, to address this dire situation, I humbly propose the following policy interventions for urgent consideration by Government through the Ministry of Works and Housing, in collaboration with the Ministry of Labour, Jobs and Employment and the Ministry of Local Government, Chieftaincy and Religious Affairs;

1. Develop and implement a comprehensive national policy for regulating billboard installation and high-rise advertising with a strong focus on occupational safety.
2. Institute a mandatory insurance scheme for workers engaged in a billboard installation and high-rise construction activities, providing coverage for injury, disability, or death.
3. Mandate the use of certified protective gear and safety equipment, such as helmets, harness, and scaffold with clear enforcement mechanism.

4. Empower and resource the MMDAs to monitor and enforce safety compliance on construction and advertising sites across their jurisdictions.
5. Collaborate with the key stakeholders, including the Advertisers Association of Ghana, the Ghana Trade Union Congress, civil society organisations, and technical institutions to develop and disseminate safety standards, training models, and ethical operational guidelines.

Mr Speaker, this is not just about protecting livelihood, it is about protecting human lives. No Ghanaian should be forced to choose between earning a living and preserving their lives. As we continue to promote job creation and urban growth, we must ensure that dignity, safety, and justice remain at the core of the development agenda.

I respectfully urge this House and relevant state agencies to act swiftly and decisively. Let us not wait for the next preventable tragedy to occur before we respond.

Mr Speaker, I want to use this opportunity to thank you and the good people of Domeabra Obom.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, the Statement has been ably made. It is now time for contributions.

Yes, Hon Zuwera Mohammed Ibrahimah?

Ms Zuwera Mohammed Ibrahimah (NDC —Salaga South): Mr Speaker, thank you for the opportunity. Let me commend my Colleague, Hon Isaac Awuku Yibor, MP for Domeabra Obom for this very timely Statement.

Mr Speaker, there are a lot of things that we take for granted in this country, and I think one of those is the obvious oversight that we sometimes are unable to provide over some industries and business activities in this country.

There is no doubt about the increasing number of high-rise buildings and billboards that have taken over the skylines of this country. As the maker of the Statement rightly indicated, so far, we have not been able to put in place the requisite requirements to ensure that young people, who are mostly involved in the construction of these high-rise buildings and billboards, are adequately protected. First, to guard their safety, and second, to be compensated in the event that there is any accident.

Mr Speaker, you need to drive along the motorway through to the N1, and you would see all these high-rising billboards. These days, they are even rolling videos. It is not just pictures, but videos are also running about; funerals, weddings, church conventions, Muslim conventions, among others. So, there is a lot happening there. I want to urge and to add my voice to the maker of this Statement, that it is about time that the Ministry of Works, Housing and Water Resources and the Ministry of Local Government, Chieftaincy and Religious Affairs—Because the permits to mount the billboards come from the local assemblies.

Mr Speaker, we need to begin to engage them to ensure that they require businesses who come to them for permits to provide certain documentations, especially in the area of safety and insurance. Insurance is a risk for everybody. Most businesses think that paying insurance is throwing good money away. No. That is why it is called insurance.

2:10 p.m.

The artisan who is working needs a fallback position in the event that if there is any tragedy, that money cannot buy— So, when we reduce everything to money, businesses are not willing to insure their staff, employees, and businesses. Then, when they go and are maimed—

Mr Speaker, all these people who work in this industry are from our constituencies. You and I know that when they have no fallback position, they come to the Member of Parliament. We become the insurance.

Mr Speaker, we have a duty to ensure that the right thing is done. So that people can be protected as they go about working to earn their daily bread.

Thank you very much.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: On this note, I will move to Minority Leadership. Is there any comment?

Yes, Majority Leadership, would you yield to your back?

Yes, Hon Member, you have the floor?

Ms Rita Naa Odoley Sowah (NDC — Dadekotopon): Mr Speaker, thank you for the opportunity to contribute to the Statement, and I want to commend the maker of the Statement.

Mr Speaker, the Government has realised how the advertising space is unsanitised. So a committee has been formed under the Ministry of Local Government, Chieftaincy and Religious Affairs, which is a technical working committee, to ensure that we work with the Assemblies to get the space sanitised; that is, the indiscriminate mounting of billboards. That is billboards that are mounted above the height at which they are supposed to go.

Mr Speaker, I am just from a meeting with some members of the technical working committee, and we will move out very soon, before Christmas, to ensure that where billboards are mounted and they are not supposed to be, we are going to pull them down, working together with the Assemblies — that is, the Metropolitan, Municipal and District Assemblies (MMDAs). Sometimes, we would realise that some of these billboards are mounted at night, and the Assemblies are not aware, but that should not be an excuse. So, we are all going to work together in this space because His Excellency, the President of the Republic of Ghana, John Dramani Mahama, is not happy with what is going on.

For instance, a place like the Airport — when we get to the Airport Roundabout — we would see indiscriminate mounting of billboards. As my sister, Ms Zuwera, said, some of them are showing videos, and as one drives along the road, the videos fall into people's eyes, and it sometimes makes driving very difficult.

Inasmuch as we need the revenue at our various MMDAs, it does not mean that we should not adhere to the signage regulations. So, I want to assure the maker of the Statement and the House that the Ministry of Local Government, Chieftaincy and Religious Affairs, under the leadership of Mr Ahmed Ibrahim, is working closely to ensure that we sanitise the space.

When we talk about high-rise buildings, every area is zoned according to the height of the building that has to be there, but it seems we are not working with that. The Land Use and Spatial Planning Authority (LUSPA) is working together with the Physical Planning Departments of the various MMDAs to ensure that we have sanity in the industry. Most of the time, people start their buildings, and when they are given permits, they do not adhere to the permits that they have been given.

I also want to urge the MMDAs to ensure that — they are the authority in their space — that is, their municipality or district. So, if someone has applied for permits, and they have given the person permits to go through three levels, and the person goes through five levels, they have to go round to ensure that that is not done.

So, I would also want to urge all the MMDAs that they have the authority, and they have the bylaws. Let us work together to ensure that we sanitise the development space, and the signage space.

Thank you, Mr Speaker for the opportunity.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, we move to the Statement numbered (7b). standing in the name of Mr Kofi Arko Nokoe.

Legacy of Anton Wilhelm Amo – Axim's Gift to the World

Mr Kofi Arko Nokoe (NDC — Evaluate – Ajomoro – Gwira): Mr Speaker, I rise today with a deep sense of pride and reverence to draw the attention of this august House to one of Africa's — and indeed Ghana's — most remarkable but often forgotten son, Anton Wilhelm Amo, also known as William Anton Amo. Born around 1703 in Axim, in what was then the Gold Coast. Amo's life defies the limitations history often placed on Africans in the era of slavery and colonial domination. Taken as a young child to Europe — reportedly as a “gift” from the Dutch West India Company to a German Duke, Amo overcame the traumatic foundations of his displacement to rise as the first African to attend and teach at European universities.

Mr Speaker, his journey from the coastal town of Axim to the lecture halls of the University of Halle, Wittenberg, and Jena in Germany, is nothing short of

extraordinary. He earned a doctorate in Philosophy, became a lecturer and published academic works, and debated the greatest minds of the enlightenment. His contributions to literacy, Philosophy, and historical discourse challenged racial stereotypes at a time when Africans were viewed as inferior beings. Amo wrote extensively on rational thought, legal rights, and the dignity of the human being—ideas that resonate with today's principles of justice and equality. What makes his legacy even more profound is the contradiction it represents. Anton Amo was an African slave who rose to intellectual eminence in 18th Century Europe, a feat that remains inspirational centuries later. His achievements remind us of the resilience, intellect, and potential of the African spirit, even in the face of unspeakable adversity.

Mr Speaker, the story of Anton Wilhelm Amo is not only one of historical importance; it is a story of motivation and purpose for the Ghanaian youth. From his life, we learn that where one begins does not determine where they can go. We learn the importance of education, perseverance, identity, and the pursuit of excellence. In him, we see that even in chains, the African mind could soar.

Mr Speaker, I call on this House and the Government of Ghana to take deliberate steps to honour the legacy of this great son of our land.

2:20 p.m.

Among the ways we can do this are:

1. Instituting an annual Anton Amo Lecture Series on African philosophy, history, and education;
2. Erecting a monument or renaming an academic institution in his honour, especially in the Nzema area or nationally;
3. Integrating his life and works into Ghana's educational curriculum to inspire generations to come;
4. Partnering with German institutions to preserve and promote his writings and philosophy through joint academic research;
5. Establishing a scholarship or academic chair in his name focused on philosophy, African studies, and post-colonial history.

Mr Speaker, Anton Wilhelm Amo is not just a historical figure—he is a symbol of African brilliance, endurance, and contribution to global knowledge. Let us lift his name from the footnotes of European academic journals into the consciousness of every Ghanaian child. For in honouring Amo, we honour our own shared heritage.

Thank you, Mr Speaker, for this opportunity.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, Statement ably made. I give the Floor to Hon former Minister for Western Region.

Mr Kwabena Okyere Darko-Mensah (NPP — Takoradi): Mr Speaker, thank you for the opportunity. Anton Amo, as he was affectionately

called, is expected to be one of the first professors of Ghanaian origin. As a Regional Minister, when I was writing the *Discover Western Region*, I did some literary research on him, and it is known that he had died at a fort in Shama.

Mr Speaker, as of 2020, 2024 and 2025, a lot of places, streets, squares in Germany had been named after him for the work he had done on the mind, and even disputing major theses of Locke and others. Such a brilliant mind coming from Ghana clearly shows that no matter where you are born, you can shine. I believe that if you take the age at which he got his PhD, around 27 years, and professorship around 32 years, you will come to realise that Anton Wilhelm Amo had done so well to project Ghana and the black race. In fact, in his time, there was a lot of controversies around him in Germany. When he also came to Ghana, the white man, the West Indies company that had brought him to Ghana, were also afraid that because of the enlightenment he had gotten from Germany, he might spark some kind of revolution among the Africans against the white. That is one of the most important reasons why they kept him in the Fort San Sebastian, in Shama.

Mr Speaker, I do believe that all young people should appreciate that no matter where they are, no matter the colour of their skin, they can shine and be of benefit to society and the world at large. Naturally, you do not need to come from Accra to be important. If you are in your corner in Keta, in your corner in Savelugu, you are in your corner in Axim, you can still shine and make a

contribution for the progress of Ghana and the world. With these few words, Mr Speaker, I thank you for the opportunity to add to the Statement of my Hon Member from Evalue-Ajomoro-Gwira. Thank you very much, Mr Speaker.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Thank you so much. I will give the floor to the Hon Member for Tamale Central, and I will come here.

Prof Seidu Mahama Alidu (NDC — Tamale Central): Mr Speaker, thank you so much for giving me the opportunity. I also want to thank my Hon Colleague for the Statement. I think, Anton William Amo is one of the most celebrated scholars across the world. His research, his academic publications, his teachings has been exemplary and actually portraying not just the Ghanaian and the African as the best of scholars in the world, but has actually opened up opportunity for people from the developing world to be able to compete with those in the developed world. Mr Speaker, his legacy has been dotted across the world. In a lot of universities, academic institutions and departments have been named after him. There have been series of lectures to honour his memory and his legacy and contribution to academic work. His work was not only on philosophy, but it also opened up the door for resilience and equality and to upgrade the minds of the black man who at that particular point in time was thought to be inferior, to compete and challenge the dominant minds of the European world in the period of enlightenment.

Mr Speaker, I think his work has been celebrated across the world, but specifically I know in the University of Ghana as far back as 2021, there was the Median Inaugural Lecture and Symposium organised by the Marian Institute for Advanced Studies in Africa, the Department of Philosophy and then the African Institute, Kwame Nkrumah Institute of African Studies, to honour his memory. I think this was chaired by the German Ambassador to Ghana. So, I truly support the work that he has done and agree with the Hon Member that we should do more to celebrate people like that who have inspired all of us who have studied in Europe to be closely associated to his legacy and memory, and gives us a lot of opportunity to also do a lot to open more doors for our young ones who are coming up and to be able to contest in terms of academic might with the developed world in spite of the advancement in technology and the academic resources that they have.

Mr Speaker, thank you so much for the opportunity.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Leadership, I am in your hands. If you look at your back there are two standing, but it is now your turn, so whoever you yield to—It is whether either you want to yield or you want to do it yourself.

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: I will yield to my Colleague; he is from the Western Region.

Mr Isaac Boamah-Nyarko (NPP — Effia): Yes, thank you very much, Mr Speaker. Rightly so, coming from the

Western Region, I want to commend the author of this Statement, the Member of Parliament for Evalue-Ajomoro-Gwira, for bringing to our attention as a House, one of the most brilliant minds Ghana could ever produce in the 17th century.

Mr Speaker, William Anton Amo was born, as the Member said, in 1703, and by the age of four years he had been taken abroad for adoption. Over his days and years, he grew up to become one of the most powerful challenging minds that the world, particularly in Germany, where he brought his scholarliness into public display. One of the most intriguing statements that he reflected upon, for which purpose I would like to read to challenge this House, and I quote from his book, *Of the Human Mind*. He stated with your permission I beg to quote:

“Whatever feels lives, whatever lives depends on nourishment, whatever lives and depends on nourishment grows. Whatever is of this nature is in the end resolved into its basic principles. Whatever comes to be resolved into its basic principles is a complex. Every complex has its constituent parts. Whatever this is true is of its divisible body. If therefore the human mind feels, it follows that it is a divisible body.”

Mr Speaker, I am sure many people would even be confused in understanding what Anton Wilhelm Amo sought to speak on in this particular quotation. But importantly, as a country, we have not been able to honour such great people for their works and contribution to this country.

2:30 p.m.

Maternal Mortality in Ghana

That is why, if we listened to my Colleague, the Hon Member for Takoradi and the other Hon Member, they talked about Mr Amo being honoured in other jurisdictions, but not being honoured enough as a country. So, if there is a request from the Hon Member for Ghana to celebrate him and to honour him, it is the right call.

That call is also to challenge Ghanaian academia, because we have all this history with strong people, who have contributed to global minds. But as a country today, with all the education, and development that have gone on, how have we been able to transform our contemporary times, even to bring the needed development that we want to see? So, we begin by celebrating William Anton Amo for his contribution to this world, and also to remind ourselves as a people that we also have to do well to contribute to the development of this country.

We sit here as Members of Parliament and we owe it a duty, in our own small way, to also contribute to the development of this country.

Mr Speaker, with these few words, I want to commend the maker of the Statement for bringing this to our attention.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Thank you very much, Hon Member. We now move to the Statement numbered 7 (e), standing in the name of Hon Laurette Korkor Asante, Member of Parliament for Atiwa West. You have the floor.

Mrs Laurette Korkor Asante (NPP — Atiwa West): Thank you, Mr Speaker. I rise today on Order 93 of our Standing Orders with a deep sense of urgency to address an alarming phenomenon. Many young Ghanaian women are losing their lives during or shortly after childbirth.

According to the Ghana Statistical Service's 2024 Thematic Brief on Maternal Mortality, the second and most recent Maternal Health Survey conducted in 2017 estimates that Ghana's maternal mortality ratio at 310 deaths per 100,000 live births for the seven years preceding the survey. This figure is corroborated by the World Health Organization (WHO) in its 2025 *Trends in Maternal Mortality Estimates 2000 to 2023* report. Ghana's rate remains significantly higher than the United Nations (UN) Sustainable Development Goals target of 70 per 100,000 live births by 2030. So, Ghana is 310 deaths per 100,000 live births and the UN SDG goal is 70 per 100,000 live births by 2030.

A recent three-year study from the Korle-Bu Teaching Hospital from January, 2021 to December, 2023, which was published in the American Journal of Obstetrics and Gynaecology, the global report in March, 2025 of this year, reveals a shocking maternal mortality ratio of 801 per 100,000 live births over a three-year period at the Korle-Bu facility. Mr Speaker, 801; that is unacceptable.

Hypertensive disorders accounted for 40.7 per cent, while haemorrhage caused 28.4 per cent of audited maternal deaths. So, the non-audited, Lord knows. This was among girls aged 15 to 19. The maternal mortality due to hypertensive complications were as high as 529 per 100,000 in the same research report. These are not just statistics; they are lives lost to systematic failures in maternal health care.

Mr Speaker, the leading causes of these maternal deaths are postpartum haemorrhage, eclampsia, sepsis, obstructed labour, and complications from caesarean sections. These causes are well known and treatable, yet 81 per cent of pregnancy-related deaths occur at home or within 24 hours of admission by the three-year research study. This reflects the enduring impact of the “three delays”: one is deciding to seek care, and in reaching the medical facility, delays in receiving timely treatment, and delays in treatment upon arrival. These dangers are magnified by long travel distances, broken referral systems, and overstretched facilities.

Mr Speaker, an article published by the Lancet Global Health on March 7, 2025, and reported by the World Health Organization identifies haemorrhage, which is severe bleeding, and hypertensive disorders such as preeclampsia as the leading causes of maternal death globally. According to the report, these conditions accounted for approximately 50,000 to 80,000 maternal fatalities, respectively, in the year 2020.

This alarming data stems from a multi-systematic review conducted to examine the root causes of maternal deaths occurring between 2009 and 2020. Mr Speaker, these findings underscore the urgent need to strengthen maternal health systems, particularly emergency obstetric care, to prevent avoidable deaths and safeguard the lives of mothers in Ghana and the world. Sub-standard care and failures such as misdiagnosis, delayed emergency interventions, and poor resuscitation practises further compound the risk of maternal mortality.

Mr Speaker, globally, countries with robust maternal health systems report far fewer maternal deaths. Germany, for example, had a maternal mortality ratio of just four per 100,000 live births in 2023, according to the World Bank’s gender data portal. Ghana, per the Korle-Bu report that I just cited, was 801 per 100,000 live births. Germany had just four. Malaysia and Sri Lanka have achieved dramatic declines in maternal mortality by expanding community-based midwifery programmes and investing in emergency transport and referral networks, as described in the World Bank’s *Investing in Maternal Health report* and the *Sub-Saharan African Transport Policy Programme (SSATP)* analysis published in April 2025.

Mr Speaker, our healthcare professionals continue to work heroically under immense pressure, but their efforts are undermined by poor infrastructure, lack of essential medicines, and a fragile referral system.

No woman should lose her life while giving birth. Every maternal death is not just a tragedy, it is a failure of our health system, our governance, and our collective responsibility. Mr Speaker, this is not an issue for women alone; it is a national development crisis. Beyond the human cost, the economic and social impact is severe. The loss of mothers leads to broken families, reduced workforce participation, and long-term poverty, especially in rural areas.

Mr Speaker, we must act decisively to reduce maternal mortality in Ghana. As such, we must adopt a comprehensive and coordinated approach that addresses both the systemic gaps and the human realities of maternal care. To that end, Mr Speaker, we should scale up midwifery training and deployment to meet WHO's ratio of 1 to 175 provider-to-population ratio. We must also equip district hospitals with essential medical equipment, blood banks, Intensive Care Units (ICU) facilities, and essential medicines. We need to strengthen the referral system specifically for obstetric emergencies. It is essential that we institute mandatory in-hospital or clinic maternal death audits and enforce clinical protocols for emergency obstetric care.

Mr Speaker, respectfully, this House must act with urgency and resolve. Let this honourable House commit, not in words alone, but through concrete action to addressing the high incidence of maternal mortality in Ghana. There must be an enquiry as to the causes of the high rate of maternal death during childbirth or immediately after childbirth in Ghana.

Is it due to complications during natural or caesarean sections? Or is it due to lack of antenatal care? Is it due to medical negligence?

2:40 p.m.

We must investigate the causes so that they can be addressed and prevent further deaths of mothers-to-be.

Mr Speaker, let us ensure that no female in Ghana dies giving life, which death could have been prevented. Let us build a nation where motherhood is celebrated, not mourned, where giving birth in Ghana is safe and not to be feared. Mr Speaker, I was speaking to some young women in my constituency, and what they said was very depressing and sad. They said they are pregnant, in their eighth to ninth month, and their fear was giving birth.

Mr Speaker, we are in 2025, and the fear of these women is giving birth. How could that be? We must address this so that we prevent these preventable deaths, because they are preventable. The data shows that a large number of these maternal deaths are preventable. We may have some that may not be preventable, but if we look at the data, it says that a large number of the maternal deaths are preventable, because the causes are known and there is treatment available.

Mr Speaker, I thank you very much for the opportunity.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, Statement ably made, it is now time for comments.

Yes, Prof Grace Ayensu-Danquah?

Prof Grace Ayensu-Danquah (NDC — Essikadu-Ketan): Thank you, Mr Speaker, for allowing me to contribute to this Statement by the Hon Member for Atiwa West.

First, I would like to commend her for bringing this issue to the floor of the House today. Ghana's maternal mortality rate is a pressing concern. As she has already alluded to, the current mortality rate is 310 deaths per 100,000 live births. The World Health Organization (WHO) standard is 70 deaths per 100,000 live births. So, we are way above that. To make this number even more frightening is the half-year report.

In 2023, half-year, we had 430 deaths. So, we had 430 women walk into hospitals or clinics pregnant, and 430 of them died. In 2024, we had 437 deaths for the half-year report. The whole year in 2024 was 819 women walked in healthy and ended up dead. In 2025, between January and June 2025, we are already up to 504.

Mr Speaker, the leading cause of these unfortunate deaths are hypertensive complications, gestational diabetes, and more importantly, postpartum haemorrhage. Basically, what happens is that after they give birth, the uterus does not contract, and then they bleed to death. These deaths are usually around the perioperative period or the postpartum period, that is, the first few days of delivery. The region in Ghana with the highest maternal

mortality is Ashanti. Ashanti has recorded the highest maternal mortality rate.

Mr Speaker, what are some of the solutions? Obviously, we have to talk about solutions. In terms of postpartum haemorrhage, there is a medication that is called Carbetocin. Basically, when the woman takes this Carbetocin after the delivery, it contracts the uterus and then it stops the uterus from bleeding. Currently, the Carbetocin we have in the country is a non-heat-stable version, and that version requires the cold chain. So, it makes the medicine very expensive. It is about GHC500.00 per dose.

But there is another version, which is a heat-stable version, that does not require the cold chain, and it is about GHC9.00 per pill. So, we are currently working on making the GHC9.00 heat-stable Carbetocin available to women in Ghana, because the number one cause of maternal mortality is postpartum haemorrhage. So, once this medicine is here, the haemorrhage or the people who are dying from postpartum haemorrhage would be decreased.

Mr Speaker, the next issue is that most of them are having these complications from being hypertensive, either pre-eclampsia or post-eclampsia, or hypertensive during the pregnancy. That is what is leading to a lot of these complications. With the Ghana Medical Trust Fund, as well as the free primary healthcare, what the Government is trying to do is to identify the high-risk women in the community before they even come to the Community-based

Health Planning and Services (CHPS) compound to deliver.

So, if the community health nurse is able to identify that a pregnant woman in the community is a potential high-risk because they have high blood pressure or they have diabetes, what we do is that we can escalate their delivery to the next level, which is basically a district hospital, so they do not end up in a CHPS compound having a baby and being complicated.

Mr Speaker, the next issue is about training. We are currently transitioning the nursing training programmes from diploma programme to degree programme. So, hopefully, as part of the training, we are going to end up with highly skilled specialised nurses who would be in the communities trying to avoid this high level of postpartum maternal mortality.

Mr Speaker, the next issue is about hypertension again. With the free primary healthcare, we would identify the patients that are hypertensive within the community. Hypertension medicine is affordable, so that if we can treat the hypertension in the communities or at the lowest level of our health system, which is the CHPS compound or the health centres, then we can avoid those who end up pregnant and those who end up with pregnancy and complications and end up in the hospital with high mortality rates.

Mr Speaker, when we look at Ashanti Region, as I said, it is the number one region with the highest morbidity and mortality. We are putting together

documentation for mentorship for the specialist doctors and nurses so that the numbers in Ashanti Region would be decreased. Once this document is done and we have done the mentorship in Ashanti Region, we would quickly scale it up to the rest of the country. The next region is Central Region. So, if the Ashanti Region and the Central Region record low numbers, this would really help us—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, your time is up.

Prof Ayensu-Danquah: Lastly, Mr Speaker, we are putting together the Reproductive, Maternal, Newborn, Child, Adolescent Health and Nutrition (RMNCAHN) Strategic Plan for 2026 and 2030 —

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, your time is up.

Dr Abdul-Khalik Mohammed Sherif (NDC — Nanton): Thank you very much, Mr Speaker.

I would want to associate myself and then say a very big thank you to the Member of Parliament for bringing this critical issue up. If we look at the issue of maternal mortality, it is just an indication of the poor nature of our health system. If we take the United States of America (USA), for example, we have a maternal mortality ratio of just about 18 per 100,000 live births. If we take Ghana, we have about 300 per 100,000 live births. This means that if we have a 60-seater Yutong bus and all of them crash at the same time, we are

going to have everybody in that bus dead. That is what it means, that per every 100,000 live births, 300 of our women would die in their bid to give birth to children.

Now, what are the key issues? If we look at maternal mortality and we do not divide it into very three critical issues, we would not appreciate the issue. The first thing is the decision to seek healthcare, and that is patient-centred. The patient first has to take a decision that she is not well and needs to get to the hospital. But let us also remember, that the decision also depends on who the person is living with. It depends on religious beliefs, traditional beliefs, *et cetera*. After this decision to seek healthcare is taken, the next decision is, she would have to get to the hospital. Where is the nearest hospital? What is the road network looking like?

2:50 p.m.

If one comes to my Constituency, Nantong, for example, it will take a pregnant woman sometimes about two to three hours. She knows she has to get to the hospital, but she needs an extra three hours to get to the nearest district hospital, which is not going to be in Nantong, but Savelugu. So first, she had a problem of decision making. Now she has decided that she will seek health care but the road network, is a problem.

But what do we have control over? That is the third category, it is at the level of the institution, our hospitals. What is our emergency preparedness for women that are pregnant? Prof Grace Ayensu-

Danquah just mentioned a very essential drug that we need, oxytocin. How available is it? Oxytocin actually should be kept at a temperature between -2 to -8°. Do we have refrigerators in our hospitals to even ensure the efficacy of the oxytocin that we are giving to these pregnant women? Because Mr Speaker, sometimes, we have the medicine, but we are not storing them at the right temperatures. So, we may be administering oxytocin, but the uterus is not going to contract.

Lastly, Mr Speaker, is the issue of human resource. What is the distribution of health care workers in this country? Most of our health care workers, our specialists, are concentrated in either Accra, in Kumasi, or in Cape Coast. What happens to that pregnant patient who has found herself in the Savannah Region, who needs a specialist obstetrician, gynaecologist, to look at the complications that Prof Ayensu-Danquah was talking about? That is why I am happy that the Ministry of Health has agreed to look at our human resource system. Must we keep all our doctors, our specialists in Korle Bu Teaching Hospital? Must we keep all our specialists in Komfo Anokye Teaching Hospital? We would need to decentralise this. Yes, there has been task shifting where some level of what we call community health nurses have been trained to do some level of midwifery care, but is that what we want as a country?

Those of us in this Chamber are all part of the problem. I am part of the problem. We are all part of the problem. For example, if I have a doctor who is my

Constituent and is posted to the Northern Region, and he comes to me that Hon, I have been sent to the Northern Region but I do not want to go there, my next action would be to look for a way to get this doctor not to go to the Northern Region but what I have done by helping him not go to the Northern Region is that I am contributing to that maternal mortality ratio we are talking about.

Mr Speaker, it is time, as a country, we decide which road we want to go. There has been a lot of investment in health. At least, the uncapping of the National Health Insurance Fund has made money accessible and readily available to health facilities to acquire essential medicine, and equipment. The coming of the Primary Health System will also bring health to the doorstep of the people. The CHPS compound we are running was supposed to be the very first point for our health care system. But it is our CHPS concept where we live up to—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, conclude on your comment.

Dr Mohammed Sherif: With these few words, Mr Speaker, I am grateful for the opportunity.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Majority Leadership?

Yes, Hon Member for Sunyani West, you have the floor.

Ms Millicent Amankwah (NDC — Sunyani West): Thank you, Mr Speaker, for giving me the opportunity to comment on this important Statement by my Colleague on the other Side.

Mr Speaker, this issue is very critical and I will personally be an advocate because I have experienced this. If it was not by God's grace, I would not be alive by now. Before I go to my personal experience, I will talk about the roads. The roads in some of our rural areas are so bad that it is difficult for constituents to get to the hospital on time, and I believe we need to give it much attention. Mr Speaker, during my daughter's birth, it got to a point that I had just enough energy to see whatever the midwife was doing. Then I heard her mention, "Jesus" and I asked myself, what exactly was happening. My baby girl kept crying. I had lost my mom about 12 years ago so one of my aunties came to help me bath my little girl after I was discharged.

Mr Speaker, we know our old mothers, they would want to check all the parts of a baby, like the hands, the legs, to see if the child was really healthy. So, she told me it looked like something was not right with a part of the baby's body. I got scared and decided to take the baby back to the hospital, because I remembered when I was taking her out of the hospital, the doctors had grouped and were having a discussion about my baby. So, I kept asking myself, what was happening? When I got to the hospital, the midwife was done with her shift and had left, and there was a new midwife on duty. But she said she did not understand what was happening. So, I asked whether we could take the folder and find out what transpired during the delivery, but when we took the folder, there were no records.

Then I asked if we could call the general doctor, because I saw him there while they were having the discussion. When he came, he said, it was a normal thing that has happened. During delivery, the baby got stuck at the shoulder and while she was being pulled out, her shoulder got overstretched. So, she had some pain in the shoulder, and could not move the hand, so they decided to put her hand in a sling for a week, and later take her for physiotherapy.

Mr Speaker, I am saying this as a concerned mother, because when I took her for physiotherapy, a large number of kids were undergoing therapy. I engaged some of the mothers, and they said, because of these things that happened during birth, some people feel that their children are disabled, so even their husbands are not appreciative and welcoming of the child. Mr Speaker, one can imagine the trauma.

So Mr Speaker, there are some kids on the streets who form part of the disabled community, meanwhile, it is sometimes the negligence of some medical practitioners and these are matters we need to pay key attention to and be careful about because it is a matter of life and death.

When we investigate and notice that these are negligence of medical practitioners, what do we do about it? Not everyone has money to take up a legal stance. Even at the physiotherapy, some of the nurses were not even concentrating during the physiotherapy. So, I had to speak to the Director to bring the baby home to continue with the

exercise. By God's grace, she fully recovered. But I imagine what other kids who were unable to get the attention, opportunity, and care because their mothers would have to take a car to the Komfo Anokye physiotherapy—I was not surprised when the Deputy Minister for Health made reference to the high mortality rate in the Ashanti Region.

So, Mr Speaker, by concluding, I think this is a very important Statement made by my Colleague, and we really need to pay key attention in solving it.

Thank you for the opportunity given to me.

3:00 p.m.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: We will move to another Statement. Hon Member, we have set the ground rules, and I am going strictly by them.

Statement numbered (c), by Mr Seidu Alhassan Alajor.

Production of Sesame and its Economic Benefit to Rural Farmers in Chereponi

Mr Seidu Alhassan Alajor (NDC — Chereponi): Mr Speaker, thank you for the opportunity for allowing me to make this Statement on the production of sesame and its economic benefit to rural farmers in Chereponi, North East Region.

Mr Speaker, sesame is a flowering plant cultivated for its edible seeds, which are rich in oil. It is a resilient crop

well-suited for dry conditions and plays a significant role in many parts of Africa, particularly in the Sahel regions. Research indicates that Sudan is currently the largest producer globally, followed by countries such as Nigeria, Burkina Faso, Mali, Tanzania and Ghana.

In Ghana, sesame is mainly grown in Chereponi and its neighbouring district in the Northern Region by 88 per cent of its smallholder farmers, typically ranging from 0.3 to 5 hectares. The average yield of sesame in Ghana is approximately 3 bags or 100 kilogrammes per hectare, based on recent data from the Ministry of Food and Agriculture. The cost of production for growing sesame on an acre is reported to be GH¢1,420, but that yield can vary based on farming practise and environmental factors.

Mr Speaker, a 2010 study revealed that the average yield of sesame in Ghana was 688 kilogrammes per hectare. Sesame production is a vital source of income for many farmers, especially in the rural areas of northern Ghana. The sesame sub-sector provides over 10,000 permanent and seasonal jobs, particularly for farmers, labourers and intermediaries. Additionally, the off-farm activities associated with the marketing, distribution and processing create more than 15,000 jobs annually.

Sesame farming is particularly prominent in Northern Ghana, with over 24,000 farmers in the Northeast Region who engage in sesame production. In Chereponi alone, over 1,400 farmers

produce more than 1,900 metric tonnes of sesame annually.

Mr Speaker, beyond employment, sesame exports have become a key contributor to Ghana's foreign exchange earnings. In 2021/2023, sesame seed exports from Ghana yielded around US\$120 million annually, with a peak of over US\$687 million. This has positioned Ghana as one of Africa's leading sesame exporters, and projections suggest that Ghana's sesame farming will grow by 4.27 per cent annually between 2022 and 2026, reaching nearly US\$7 billion by 2027.

Mr Speaker, I must also highlight that sesame farming is contributing to poverty reduction by providing income, generating opportunities for smallholder farmers and their families. Moreover, it is used in various food products like pastry, bread and snacks. The growing demand for sesame-blended food among health-conscious consumers is driving the demand and production of the seed. However, price fluctuation associated with the commodity is holding back the growth of sesame seeds.

Consumption of the seed in Ghana is low due to the lack of public awareness about its usefulness and health benefits. In addition, the perception of the seed as a cash crop cultivated for export rather than a food source also contributes to the low domestic patronage. In a news article by Ghana News Agency in 2023, it was reported that most farmers in the Sissala, an enclave in the Upper West Region, which produces about 100,000 tonnes of maize yearly, are shifting to sesame

farming due to rising costs in maize production.

Mr Speaker, the benefits of sesame farming are numerous. It has diversified Ghana's agriculture system, reducing the country's reliance on traditional crops like maize, millet and groundnuts. This diversification provides farmers with an alternative income source and strengthens resilience against market volatility. In fact, many smallholder farmers in Chereponi refer to sesame as their "Cocoa Farm". The high demand for sesame has also created employment opportunities at various stages of production, from farming to processing. Both skilled and unskilled labourers are engaged in the value chain, contributing to rural development. For example, a sesame farmer in Chereponi can support their family, pay school fees and meet other basic needs. This makes the sesame seed a driver of rural development.

Mr Speaker, despite these benefits, the sesame industry faces several challenges, especially in Chereponi. One of the main issues is low productivity, as sesame yields in Ghana are relatively low compared to other producers. This is due to outdated farming practices, limited access to improved varieties and inadequate quality standards along the value chain, which impacts the competitiveness of Ghana's sesame on the international market.

Additionally, sesame farmers face difficulties such as a poor road network, which forces them to transport their product to Togo's market. The absence of a fixed market price and the influence

of middlemen also affect the producer price. Other challenges include lack of proper storage facilities, limited monitoring by agriculture extension officers and inadequate pest control methods, which lead to reduced yields and poor-quality harvest. Moreover, poor post-harvest practices, such as inadequate drying and improper storage, result in significant losses and reduce profitability for farmers.

Mr Speaker, to address these challenges, I recommend that the Government, through the Ministry of Food and Agriculture, invest in research to develop high-yield pest-resistant sesame varieties and improve farming techniques. The Ministry and its relevant agencies should also provide market support, thus improving access to reliable market information and establishing partnerships between farmers and exporters to ensure better prices and market access for farmers.

Mr Speaker, the Ministry of Food and Agriculture should, as part of efforts to ensure good yields, provide a training programme on quality control, post-harvest management and pest control to improve production standards and reduce losses.

Mr Speaker, the Government should also invest in improving the road network in the Chereponi area, especially in farming communities within Chereponi, and establish an irrigation system to support sesame farming, which will ensure productivity and transportation. I must emphasise that all roads in the Chereponi district are in

a completely deplorable state, and I encourage the Government to support the construction of roads to support farmers in the sesame industry.

Again, the Government, through its sector Ministers, should assist sesame farmers to assess financial support for farmers to enable them to invest in a better farming method, storage facilities and equipment.

In conclusion, Mr Speaker, sesame production presents a significant opportunity for economic growth and poverty alleviation in Chereponi and the Northern Ghana enclave. By addressing these challenges and investing in the sector, we can create sustainable livelihoods for farmers and position Ghana as a global leader in sesame production.

3:10 p.m.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, the Statement has been made. Any comment? Yes, Hon Member?

Mr Bataglia Issah Mohammed (NDC — Sissala East): Thank you Mr Speaker, I start by thanking my Colleague, Hon Alajor, for making this wonderful Statement.

Mr Speaker, the issue of sesame has become the new normal, mostly serving as an intervening crop that supports farmers because of its short lifespan, right from the germination to the harvest. Farmers use this crop to raise money to be able to do their farming work. As he mentioned, sesame has been able to keep

the youth out of the forest and the water bodies especially in Tumu and other surrounding communities in the Sissala East. Today, many young ones in the community venture into sesame production, and they make good monies to support their families and other activities that they want to engage in.

Last year, at the peak season, it will interest the House to know that a bag of sesame weighing 100 kg went as high as GH¢4,000.00; that is sesame. So, in Tumu and its surrounding villages, many people say and my Colleague indicated that, it is not just the Cocoa, but it is also gold in the form of white and black.

I also appreciate the point that the Government and through the Minister for Food and Agriculture, should look into farming this crop, so that we are able to highlight the importance of it to the many young people who are there idling. More so because of the fact that most of us are border towns. For instance, my Constituency shares a border with Burkina Faso. Having the youth sit and do nothing, without any support, is not just an economic problem, but a national security concern.

With this, I also want to add the Ministry of Food and Agriculture to support in any form that will make farming of sesame, a point way for the youth to go into.

Thank you, Mr Speaker for this opportunity.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Thank you, Hon Member. Yes, I would come to

Minority Leadership, then I would come to the Majority Leadership.

Yes, Minority Chief Whip?

Mr Frank Annoh-Dompreh (NPP — Nsawam/Adoagyiri): Mr Speaker, it would not be out of place if I start off by commending Mr Alhassan Alajor, the Member of Parliament for Chereponi, for bringing this matter onto the House floor for a discussion. I commend him because, sesame is one of the most beneficial products that has often been underrated. The maker of this Statement mentioned in passing, reasons probably why we have not paid attention to this product.

The benefits are not far-fetched and is known. I am surprised to hear that a bag of sesame is of that value. If it is the case, it could be the next gold in that part of the country. It has a huge potential. I am surprised that it has not received the necessary attention and the call that is due it. I can only commend the Member of Parliament and also give him the assurance that I will be part of any effort, in advocating for the anchoring of this product in the narrative of the Minister for Agriculture and other Ministries who matter as far as this product is concerned.

Mr Speaker, this is just the tip of the iceberg; there is a plethora of them. So, for many of these essential products. We are told there are countries in the world whose soil is not that fertile. In any part of our country, you can plant anything, it would germinate and would successfully blossom. So, it feeds into one problem that we have as a country, where we

often tend to sleep on our oars. The things we have to do to change our economic fortunes, we do not do them.

We always talk about the traditional crops. Sesame could be classified as a non-traditional export crop, which could be exploited. Mango, in the parts of the Eastern Region—In fact, Ghana is the only country in the entire world where we have two maximum seasons of mango growth. There is nowhere in the world. South Africa, resorts to irrigation—*[Interruption]*—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, Order! Order!

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: Mr Speaker, I will not yield to that invitation. Mr Speaker, I am looking at you and my attention is focused on you.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, do not be tempted.

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: Yes. So, sesame could be the most important non-traditional export crop or product that we can exploit. It is not just for the health benefits, but also for poverty reduction. I am aware the constituents are already farming in it, but yet they are doing it at a scale that is minimal. Why? Because they do not have the necessary oxygen that will make them expand. They also do not have the know-how.

If the Minister for Food and Agriculture—I wish Mr Eric Opoku, whom I know is a very active person when it comes to such matters. If the Minister for Food and Agriculture and

even the Presidency could give it a certain boost, I am sure it will change the lives of the constituents and the Hon Member of Parliament will be a happy person.

Mr Speaker, because of the health benefits and the unique nature of the product, I will implore you that probably this Statement is forwarded to our own Mr Eric Opoku, so that it does not just become one of the Statements that is made and then it gets onto the record. It will get onto the record, but it must attract or elicit the need for action from the duty-bearers to change the narrative.

Having said that, I am sure the constituents—He has won his next election—His constituents must be very happy and proud of him for zeroing in on this matter.

Let us not let the narrative end here. Let us continue with it. Mr Eric Opoku is a very fine gentleman. I am sure he would be happy to work closely with the Hon Member to change the narrative.

Mr Speaker, having said that, I thank you for the opportunity.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Thank you very much.

Yes, Deputy Majority Leader?

George Kweku Ricketts-Hagan (NDC — Cape Coast South): Thank you very much.

Mr Speaker, first of all, I want to thank all the Hon Members who made a

Statement today on both Sides and the rich contributions that came out of it.

Mr Speaker, on the Statement that Mr Alhassan has just made about sesame, I want to add my voice to what the Minority Chief Whip said, that we have a lot of plants in this country that we do not pay much attention to. But a lot of these are things that we can actually earn money from, basically from exporting this. I think we will all have to add our voice.

3.20 p.m.

This is obviously grown in a certain region of Ghana and small farmers actually depend on this for their livelihood. But it has a potential of becoming much bigger than it being situated in a small area and making small money or small benefit for the farmers over there. There are a lot of these plants, or a lot of these that we produce, that can actually, with the right investments and support, be grown on a much larger scale that will be able to earn Ghana some kind of foreign revenue.

Mr Speaker, I think we all know of sesame oil. It has huge importance in Europe and I know of this, that in Italy in particular, it is used for cooking and many other things. I think the largest country that does this in the continent is Sudan and at the moment, with the situation going on in Sudan, it is very difficult to get this in the quantities that are required in many places, especially Europe. So, it may grow in other parts. I do not know how much research has been done to know in which part of the

country this will actually grow. At the moment, it is in the Chereponi area and the districts around it. But this could also grow in other parts of the country where we are trying to encourage people to go into farming and make it a profitable business or industry.

Mr Speaker, these are some of the things that we need to be looking at, rather than the usual things that we focus on in terms of bringing in revenue to Ghana. I think that my Hon Brother's constituents, especially the farmers, will be very happy to see their MP bring this to the attention of the world. It definitely has benefits, but also challenges and these challenges will have to be looked at, and especially brought to the attention of the Minister for Food and Agriculture, whom I believe will be interested in supporting these kinds of projects. Not only in the area where this grows at the moment, but to actually do a scientific test to see whether this will grow elsewhere, because the potential of this being a foreign exchange earner is huge.

Mr Speaker, I thank the maker of the Statement, and all others who made Statements that we have all not been able to contribute to.

Mr Speaker, I also want to take the opportunity to apologise to those who have Statements advertised, but could not be taken. Hon Solomon Kuyon had an emergency. He communicated that and I believe you are aware of it. That is why we skipped. So, we would make sure that his Statement and the others that were not taken today would be rescheduled so that they would be able to make their Statements as well.

Mr Speaker, I would like to end here, and thank you very much for today.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Thank you, Deputy Majority Leader.

Hon Members, I will give some consequential directives, particularly regarding the Statement made by Mrs Laurette Korkor Asante and Mr Seidu Alhassan Alajor. I will direct the Clerk to transmit the Statement made by Mrs Korkor Asante on mortality rates to the Minister for Health and that of Mr Seidu Alhassan Alajor to the Minister for Food and Agriculture. I so direct.

Statement time is ended. Any indication?

Deputy Majority Leader (Mr George Kweku Ricketts-Hagan): Mr Speaker, I think we have exhausted what we planned to do today, and as you are aware, tomorrow we have a workshop. So, Hon Members want to be able to leave here in a good time to prepare for that workshop.

Mr Speaker, we have not been here for five hours, so I would like to move a Motion that this House adjourns till next week, Tuesday, 10 o'clock.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Motion moved. Any seconder?

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: Mr Speaker, I have no issues seconding the Motion, except to remind the Majority Leader that we still do not have clarity on whether the post-Budget workshop would be residential or not. The Majority

Chief Whip related to me that we would have to meet the Clerk to get it firmed up. I want to plead with you to add your authority, because between now and tomorrow is a short time, so that we can get —

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, the indication is that, previously, we did it in Parliament and it was non-residential, and this one will also be non-residential. So, we need to get it clear. Until otherwise changed, we should make up our mind and prepare that it is non-residential.

Mr Ricketts-Hagan: Mr Speaker, precisely what you have said, that as it stands, it is non-residential. But my understanding is that the Whips are

working behind the scenes to see if that can be changed. We would definitely add our voice to bring finality to what we are going to be doing tomorrow. Thank you.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Frank Annoh-Dompreh?

Minority Chief Whip (Mr Frank Annoh-Dompreh): Mr Speaker, I rise to second the Motion moved by the Deputy Majority Leader of the House.

Question put and Motion agreed to.

ADJOURNMENT

The House was accordingly adjourned at 3:28 p.m. till Tuesday, 18th November, 2025, at 10:00 a.m.

